GUESSS

Global University Entrepreneurial Spirit Students' Survey

Student Entrepreneurship in the Philippines
2025 GUESSS National Report



ATENEO DE MANILA UNIVERSITY
JOHN GOKONGWEI SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT

ATENEO INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY OFFICE

PHILIPPINES

National Report 2025

Global University Entrepreneurial Spirit Students' Survey

by

John Luis D. Lagdameo

Daniella Annika A. Guerrero

Bryan James E. Erfe

Steve M. Chaves

John Gokongwei School of Management (JGSOM)

Ateneo Intellectual Property Office (AIPO)

Ateneo de Manila University

Quezon City, Philippines

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University	Main Contact
Adamson University (AdU)	Dr. Rosula S.J. Reyes
Ateneo de Manila University (ADMU)	Mr. Bryan James E. Erfe / Dr. John Luis D. Lagdameo
Bataan Peninsula State University (BPSU)	Engr. Michaela T. Espino
Caraga State University (CarSU)	Dr. Jeffrey T. Dellosa
De La Salle - College of Saint Benilde (Benilde)	Mr. Paul Amerigo Pajo, Jr.
De La Salle University (DLSU)	Atty. Christopher E. Cruz
Holy Angel University (HAU)	Engr. Edward P. Lacson
Mapua University (MAPUA)	Dr. Jonathan W. L. Salvacion
Philippine Normal University (PNU)	Dr. Darryl Roy T. Montebon
Polytechnic University of the Philippines (PUP)	Dr. Philip P. Ermita
Rizal Technological University (RTU)	Mr. John Oliver P. Distor
Technological Institute of the Philippines (TIP)	Engr. Shearyl U. Arenas
Thames International School	Mr. Jaime Noel Santos
University of Asia and the Pacific (UA&P)	
University of Santo Tomas (UST)	Rev. Fr. Jannel N. Abogado
University of the Cordilleras (UC)	Dr. Thelma D. Palaoag
University of the Philippines Diliman (UPD)	Mr. Edison Cruz D. Cruz / Mr. Luis Diego D. Lee
University of the Philippines in Los Baños (UPLB)	
University of the Philippines Manila (UPM)	
Xavier University - Ateneo de Cagayan (XU)	Mr. Immanuel D. Calunod

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0.1 Executive Summary

The **GUESSS 2025 Philippines National Report** reveals a dynamic and evolving entrepreneurial landscape among university students in the Philippines. Drawing from 669 respondents across more than 20 higher education institutions, the findings highlight strong entrepreneurial aspirations but uneven educational exposure and structural challenges influencing entrepreneurial behavior. Overall, the report identifies a large latent entrepreneurial pipeline and notable early-stage engagement, underscoring opportunities for universities, policymakers, and ecosystem actors to strengthen innovation capacity and youth entrepreneurship.

Expanding access to entrepreneurship education emerges as the most effective lever for cultivating entrepreneurial intention and skill development. Universities can activate this latent pipeline through three key interventions: **Entrepreneurial Discovery Tracks** that expose students from all disciplines to innovation and venture creation; **Post-Graduation Incubation Programs** that extend institutional support to alumni; and **Career-to-Startup Bridging Initiatives** that connect early-career experience with entrepreneurial development. Combined with outcomes-driven pedagogy and experiential learning, these strategies can transform entrepreneurial aspiration into tangible enterprise creation. Universities should also advocate for a **student-level temporary business permit**, providing a regulated, low-risk environment for students to operate small ventures while enrolled.

To sustain long-term growth, universities must cultivate an international mindset among student entrepreneurs. Global exposure through exchange programs, cross-border incubation, and international mentorship networks enables Filipino founders to scale ventures beyond domestic markets and compete globally. Persistent ecosystem barriers—particularly limited access to financing, weak STEM-business collaboration, and fragmented institutional coordination—require collective action through a **Philippine University Entrepreneurship and Innovation Consortium (PUEIC)**. This alliance would allow institutions to advocate jointly for policy reform, resource sharing, and standardized entrepreneurship education. By embracing global collaboration and innovation-driven learning, universities and policymakers can unlock the latent entrepreneurial potential of Filipino youth and position the Philippines as a regional hub for inclusive, internationally competitive entrepreneurship.

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1. Introduction

The **Global University Entrepreneurial Spirit Students' Survey (GUESSS)** represents a prominent longitudinal international research consortium established in 2003 by the **Swiss Institute of Small Business and Entrepreneurship (KMU-HSG)** at the **University of St. Gallen**, in collaboration with the **University of Bern (IMU-U)**. This global initiative systematically examines the entrepreneurial intentions, behaviors, and multi-dimensional attitudes of university students through a rigorous, standardized survey instrument administered via a network of national academic partners. GUESSS has evolved into a cornerstone of entrepreneurship research, providing high-fidelity data that underpins scholarly publications, evidence-based policy frameworks, and practitioner-oriented studies, thereby advancing the global discourse on the role of higher education in nurturing entrepreneurial ecosystems.

In the context of the 2025 GUESSS cycle, Ateneo de Manila University serves as the country delegate for the Philippines, responsible for leading institutional outreach to partner Higher Education Institutions (HEIs), ensuring methodological and data integrity, and authoring the Philippine GUESSS national report. This comprehensive report provides an analysis of the entrepreneurial intentions and activities characteristic of the Filipino students. A critical component of this initiative is the institutional partnership with the Ateneo John Gokongwei School of Management (JGSOM) and the Ateneo Intellectual Property Office (AIPO), which bridges the nexus between theoretical research and practical application by aligning insights with intellectual property development, technology transfer mechanisms, and startup incubation pathways. Through the synergy between JGSOM and AIPO, Ateneo de Manila University reinforces its commitment to advancing evidence-based entrepreneurship education and contributing to robust innovation policy within the Philippines.

These details are consistent with the official description in the **GUESSS 2025 Philippine National Report** prepared by the **John Gokongwei School of Management, Ateneo de Manila University**, and the **Ateneo Intellectual Property Office**

1.1 The 2025 Global GUESSS Project

The **GUESSS Global Report 2025** presents one of the world's largest studies on student entrepreneurship, drawing on **196,162 responses from 66 countries**. The report reveals that student entrepreneurial intentions have reached a **historic low**, with only **15.4% planning to become entrepreneurs directly after graduation** and **28.3% within five years**—the lowest five-year intention rate ever recorded in GUESSS. Despite this decline, entrepreneurship remains a **strategic career path**, with many students adopting a "*first employee, then entrepreneur*" approach. The study also finds substantial entrepreneurial activity: **16.5% of students are nascent entrepreneurs**, and **6.4% already run active ventures**, many of which show **medium-to-good performance** and are concentrated in creative and digital sectors.

The report highlights several key factors shaping student entrepreneurship globally. **University environments**, including entrepreneurship courses and supportive campus climates, significantly influence entrepreneurial intentions and activities. A persistent **gender gap** remains, with females consistently showing lower entrepreneurial participation. Additionally, **individual-level entrepreneurial orientation (IEO)** emerges as a strong predictor of entrepreneurial behavior. Cross-country comparisons show wide variation, with **developing countries generally exhibiting higher entrepreneurial intentions and activity** than developed ones. Overall, the 2025 findings depict a generation that values entrepreneurship but often delays entry to gain experience, resources, and confidence before launching ventures.

1.2 Participating Universities

The survey engaged 20 partner universities across Luzon, Visayas, and Mindanao, plus respondents from other institutions. While the institutional reach is broad, the sample remains concentrated: the top four contributing universities—Ateneo de Manila University (**25.6%**), Technological Institute of the Philippines (**12.9%**), Polytechnic University of the Philippines (**12.9%**), and the University of the Cordilleras (**11.8%**)—account for approximately **63%** of the total 669 respondents. The remaining **36.9%** comprises 16 other partner institutions (**21.5%**) and respondents who selected an unlisted university (**15.4%**).

Table 1
University Distribution

University	n	Share
Ateneo de Manila University (ADMU)	*171*	*25.6%*
Polytechnic University of the Philippines (PUP)	*86*	*12.9%*
Technological Institute of the Philippines (TIP)	*86*	*12.9%*
University of the Cordilleras (UC)	*79*	*11.8%*
Adamson University (AdU)	*35*	*5.2%*
Caraga State University (CarSU)	*27*	*4.0%*
Xavier University - Ateneo de Cagayan (XU)	*19*	*2.8%*
De La Salle - College of Saint Benilde (Benilde)	*16*	*2.4%*
De La Salle University (DLSU)	*8*	*1.2%*
Holy Angel University (HAU)	*8*	*1.2%*
Rizal Technological University (RTU)	*8*	*1.2%*

University	n	Share
University of the Philippines Diliman (UPD)	*8*	*1.2%*
Thames International School	*5*	*0.7%*
Mapua University (MAPUA)	*2*	*0.3%*
University of Santo Tomas (UST)	*2*	*0.3%*
University of the Philippines in Los Baños (UPLB)	*2*	*0.3%*
Bataan Peninsula State University (BPSU)	*1*	*0.1%*
Philippine Normal University (PNU)	*1*	*0.1%*
University of Asia and the Pacific (UA&P)	*1*	*0.1%*
University of the Philippines Manila (UPM)	*1*	*0.1%*
Others	*103*	*15.4%*
Total	**669**	**100.0%**

2. Demographics

2.1 Age Profile

The age distribution reflects a predominantly young cohort, with the vast majority of respondents falling between **18 and 25 years old**, and a modal age of **21-22**, which accounts for **38.3%** of valid responses. The cumulative pattern shows that **96%** of individuals are aged **25 or below**, indicating a tightly clustered early-adult population typical of undergraduate or early-career university students. The few older respondents are mostly attributed to **students enrolled in master's or doctoral programs**, or other non-traditional learners whose presence extends the upper range of the age distribution.

2.2 Gender

Table 2
Gender Distribution of Respondent Population

Gender	n	Share
Female	*361*	*54.0%*
Male	*300*	*44.8%*
Non-binary / Other	*8*	*1.2%*

Table 2 shows that the sample is composed predominantly of **female respondents (54.0%)**, followed by **male respondents (44.8%)**, with a small proportion identifying as **non-binary or other (1.2%)**.

2.3 Nationality

The sample is almost entirely Filipino (**97.5%**, n=652). The remaining **2.5%** indicated other nationalities, consistent with the small international student population enrolled in Philippine universities.

2.4 Study-Related Information

2.4.1 Study Level

The table on study level shows that the vast majority of respondents are **undergraduate students (95.8%)**, with only a small proportion enrolled in **graduate programs (2.2%)**, **MBA or other postgraduate studies (1.2%)**, and **PhD programs (0.6%)**. This distribution indicates that the sample is heavily concentrated at the bachelor's level. The limited representation of graduate and doctoral students suggests that entrepreneurial

intentions and activities captured in the dataset are largely shaped by undergraduate experiences and exposure to entrepreneurship education at that stage.

2.4.2 Field of Study

Table 3
Field of Study

Field of Study	n	Share
Business administration / management	*225*	*33.6%*
Other	*140*	*20.9%*
Engineering (incl. architecture)	*128*	*19.1%*
Computer sciences	*92*	*13.8%*
Natural sciences (physics, chemistry, biology)	*23*	*3.4%*
Human medicine / health sciences	*20*	*3.0%*
Social sciences (psychology, politics)	*20*	*3.0%*
Economics	*7*	*1.0%*
Law / Science of Art / Humanities / Mathematics	*14*	*2.1%*

The results show that **Business Administration and Management** is the most common field of study among respondents, accounting for **33.6%** of the total sample. This is followed by **Other fields** (**20.9%**), indicating a broad range of disciplines outside the main categories. **Engineering (including architecture)** ranks third with **19.1%**, while **Computer Sciences** represents **13.8%**, highlighting a strong presence of technical and business-oriented programs. Smaller shares are observed in **Natural Sciences** (**3.4%**), **Human Medicine/Health Sciences** (**3.0%**), and **Social Sciences** (**3.0%**). The least represented fields are **Law/Science of Art / Humanities / Mathematics** (**2.1%**) and **Economics** (**1.0%**). Overall, the data suggest that the respondent pool is predominantly composed of students from business and technical disciplines, with limited participation from the humanities and pure sciences.

…

3. Evolving Career Trajectories of Sampled University Students

3.1 Career Path Intentions

Table 4
Career Path Intentions

Career Path	Right After Studies	5 Years Later
Founder / entrepreneur (own business)	*14.2%*	*38.4%*
Employee in large business (250+ employees)	*26.2%*	*22.7%*
Employee in medium business (50–249)	*16.0%*	*5.4%*
Employee in public service	*9.0%*	*6.4%*
Employee in academia	*5.1%*	*4.9%*
Successor in family business	*3.4%*	*3.3%*
Successor in another business	*1.0%*	*2.4%*
Non-profit organization	*1.3%*	*1.0%*
Employee in small business (1–49)	*5.2%*	*2.2%*
Other / do not know yet	*18.5%*	*13.2%*

3.1.1 Introduction: From Employment to Enterprise

The sample of university students show a clear shift in career direction over time. Right after graduation, many seek the stability and structured growth offered by established firms. As their careers progress, however, they increasingly turn toward entrepreneurship. This change highlights a growing appreciation for autonomy, innovation, and self-driven career paths.

3.1.2 Entrepreneurial Ascendancy: The Emerging Priority

The data reveal a significant rise in entrepreneurial aspirations five years after the respondents' graduation. Immediately after graduation, only **14.2%** of respondents intend to start their own business, but this figure surges to **38.4%** five years later—the largest increase across all career categories. This progression suggests that many graduates view entrepreneurship as a long-term goal, preferring to first acquire professional experience, skills, and networks before launching their ventures. The trend underscores a strategic incubation phase, where early employment serves as a foundation for future enterprise creation.

3.1.3 Declining Corporate Preference: Reimagining Stability

In contrast, the appeal of traditional employment declines across all business sizes. Employment in large firms drops from **26.2%** to **22.7%**, medium-sized firms from **16.0%** to **5.4%**, and small firms from **5.2%** to **2.2%**. This downward trend signals a redefinition of career stability—from organizational security to entrepreneurial independence. The sample of university students increasingly aspire to ownership and creative control, reflecting a cultural shift toward self-employment and innovation-driven work.

3.1.4 Enduring Vocational Anchors: Public and Academic Careers

Public service and academia remain relatively stable, with only minor declines—**9.0%** to **6.4%,** and **5.1%** to **4.9%**, respectively. These fields attract individuals with purpose-driven motivations, such as civic contribution or scholarly pursuit. Their consistency contrasts sharply with the volatility of corporate and entrepreneurial preferences, highlighting the enduring appeal of mission-oriented professions.

3.1.5 Leadership Beyond Family Firms

Among the surveyed, **35.7%** mentioned that either one or both parents have an existing and active business. Among those who are potential successors to the family business, their career intentions related to family business succession remain nearly constant after five years (**3.4%** to **3.3%**). However, when asked about becoming a successor in another business, the share more than doubles (**1.0%** to **2.4%**). This shift suggests a broadening leadership ambition—students increasingly seek roles in organizations beyond their familial enterprises.

3.1.6 Declining Career Uncertainty: Maturing Intentions

The proportion of respondents uncertain about their career path decreases from **18.5%** immediately after graduation to **13.2%** after five years from graduation, indicating self-perceived clarity and self-awareness over time. This reduction may likely stem from students' expectations that increased exposure to entrepreneurial education, internships, and industry engagement, will help them refine their professional goals. Globally, the corresponding figures are **16.8%** for directly after studies, and **14.4%** five years after completion of studies. The Philippine sample exceeds the global average by 1.7 percentage points at the point of graduation, but falls below the global benchmark after five years.

3.1.7 Integrative Interpretation: Toward an Entrepreneurial Generation

Founder intention increases from **14.2%** immediately after studies to **38.4%** five years later. Career uncertainty decreases from **18.5%** to **13.2%** between the same two questions. Together, these shifts show that many students see entrepreneurship as a goal that follows initial employment reflecting aspirations of autonomy and innovation. This may have transformative potential for youth employment policy, entrepreneurial ecosystems, and economic development in the Philippines.

3.2 Alternative Career Paths Beyond Entrepreneurship

Of the 669 respondents, 531 (**79.4%**) are neither active nor nascent entrepreneurs They neither operate a business nor plan to start one soon. Their career preferences lean toward structured professional environments such as established companies, public institutions, or academia—valuing stability, mentorship, and clear career progression over entrepreneurial risk-taking.

This group highlights the diversity of career aspirations among the sample of university students. While many show increasing entrepreneurial ambition, a notable segment remains committed to non-entrepreneurial paths, pursuing meaningful roles within existing organizations and contributing through expertise, collaboration, and long-term professional development rather than venture creation

3.3 Career Choices and Entrepreneurial Intention

Entrepreneurial intention was assessed using six items adapted from the *Global University Entrepreneurial Spirit Students' Survey* (GUESSS) and the Entrepreneurial Intention Model developed by Liñán and Chen (2009). Respondents indicated their agreement with statements such as *"I am ready to do anything to be an entrepreneur"* and *"I have the strong intention to start a business someday"* on a **7-point Likert scale** ranging from **1 (strongly disagree)** to **7 (strongly agree)**. Higher scores represent stronger entrepreneurial motivation and intention, while lower scores indicate weaker agreement. This scale captures respondents' readiness, determination, and commitment to pursue entrepreneurial activities in the future (GUESSS, 2025; Liñán & Chen, 2009). These items were administered only to respondents who were neither active nor nascent entrepreneurs (n ≈ 526).

Table 5
Entrepreneurial Intention

Entrepreneurial Intention Item	Mean
I am determined to create a business in the future	*4.98*
I have the strong intention to start a business someday	*4.95*
I have very seriously thought of starting a business	*4.77*
I will make every effort to start and run my own business	*4.72*
I am ready to do anything to be an entrepreneur	*4.57*
My professional goal is to become an entrepreneur	*4.33*

The results demonstrate that the respondents possess a strong entrepreneurial mindset, with mean scores consistently above the midpoint of the 7-point scale. The highest ratings for *"I am determined to create a business in the future"* (M = 4.98) and *"I have the strong intention to start a business someday"* (M = 4.95) highlight a clear sense of determination and long-term vision among respondents. This suggests that entrepreneurship is increasingly viewed as a desirable and attainable career path.

Moderate scores for *"I have very seriously thought of starting a business"* (M = 4.77) and *"I will make every effort to start and run my own business"* (M = 4.72) indicate readiness and willingness to act, though practical challenges—such as access to capital, mentorship, and market opportunities—may influence the pace of entrepreneurial engagement. The relatively lower means for *"I am ready to do anything to be an entrepreneur"* (M = 4.57) and *"My professional goal is to become an entrepreneur"* (M = 4.33) reflect cautious optimism, suggesting that while students are motivated, they may still prioritize stability or professional experience before venturing into business.

In the Philippine higher education context, these findings underscore the importance of strengthening entrepreneurship education and support systems within universities. Institutions can play a pivotal role by integrating experiential learning, startup incubation programs, and mentorship initiatives that bridge theory and practice. Aligning with Liñán and Chen's (2009) model, which emphasizes intention as a precursor to entrepreneurial action, universities can cultivate entrepreneurial competencies and confidence through interdisciplinary collaboration and exposure to real-world business challenges.

Ultimately, the data suggest that the sample of university students are not only interested in entrepreneurship but are developing the mindset and determination necessary to contribute to the country's innovation-driven economy. By fostering an enabling environment, higher education institutions can transform these intentions into sustainable entrepreneurial ventures that drive inclusive growth and job creation.

3.4 Share of Nascent and Active Entrepreneurs

The entrepreneurial status results, based on **questions 2.11** (*"Are you currently owning and managing a business that has generated regular sales over the last 3 months?"*) and **2.12** ("*Are you currently in the process of creating an own business that has not generated regular sales yet?"*) of GUESSS, reveal that most respondents are **not yet engaged in entrepreneurship**, with **79.4%** classified as *aspiring, employed, or undecided*.

Table 6
Entrepreneurial Status

Entrepreneurial Status	n	Share of Sample
Currently own and manage a business (Active)	*55*	*8.2%*
Currently creating a business, not yet generating sales (Nascent)	*103*	*15.4%*
Neither (aspiring/employed/undecided)	*531*	*79.4%*

Meanwhile, **15.4%** of respondents are *nascent entrepreneurs*—those actively developing a business but not yet generating sales—and **8.2%** are *active entrepreneurs* who already own and manage a business. Twenty respondents belong to both groups. In total, 138 students (**20.6%**) are engaged in business creation. While the majority remain in the pre-entrepreneurial stage, this pattern reflects a promising entrepreneurial pipeline among the sample students, where interest and intention are gradually evolving into tangible entrepreneurial activity.

4. Drivers of Entrepreneurial Intentions

4.1 University Context

4.1.1 University Entrepreneurship Environment

Table 7
University Entrepreneurship Environment

Climate Dimension	Mean
My university encourages students in entrepreneurial activities (3.1)	*5.25*
Students can get entrepreneurship-related advice and guidance easily (3.2)	*5.18*
The atmosphere inspires me to develop ideas for new businesses (3.3)	*4.99*
There is a favorable climate for becoming an entrepreneur (3.4)	*4.96*

The survey results highlight a **positive entrepreneurial climate** within the sampled Philippine higher education institutions. Respondents evaluated their universities across four dimensions using a 7-point Likert scale (1 = *not at all*, 7 = *very much*). All dimensions scored above 4.9, indicating strong institutional support for entrepreneurship. The highest mean score was for *"My university encourages students in entrepreneurial activities"* (M = 5.25), underscoring universities' active role in promoting innovation and entrepreneurial engagement among students.

Despite this favorable climate, an exposure gap persists—**33.3%** of respondents reported no formal entrepreneurship education. Expanding compulsory and elective entrepreneurship modules across disciplines could strengthen the entrepreneurial pipeline and help translate institutional support into sustained entrepreneurial outcomes.

4.1.2 On Entrepreneurship Education

Table 8
Entrepreneurship Education Exposure

Statement	False (%)	True (%)
I have not attended a course on entrepreneurship so far. (3.5)	*66.7*	*33.3*
I have attended at least one entrepreneurship course as elective. (3.6)	*70.3*	*29.7*
I have attended at least one entrepreneurship course as compulsory part of my studies. (3.7)	*57.5*	*42.5*
I am studying in a specific program on entrepreneurship. (3.8)	*83.1*	*16.9*

Statement	False (%)	True (%)
I chose to study at this university mainly because of its strong entrepreneurial reputation. (3.9)	*83.7*	*16.3*

The results reveal varying levels of exposure to entrepreneurship education within sampled Philippine higher education institutions. About **33.3%** of students reported that they had *not attended any entrepreneurship course*, while **29.7%** had taken at least one *elective course*. In contrast, **42.5%** had attended entrepreneurship courses as a *compulsory component* of their degree programs, suggesting that institutional requirements play a major role in introducing students to entrepreneurial learning. Only **16.9%** were enrolled in a *specialized entrepreneurship program*, and **16.3%** chose their university primarily for its *strong entrepreneurial reputation*.

The predominance of compulsory coursework (**42.5%**) also indicates that entrepreneurship education in the sample is largely driven by curricular mandates rather than voluntary participation. While this ensures baseline entrepreneurial literacy, the relatively low engagement in specialized programs and elective courses points to an opportunity for universities to deepen entrepreneurial competencies. Strengthening elective offerings, specialized tracks, and branding around entrepreneurship could help institutions cultivate more advanced entrepreneurial skills and foster a stronger innovation culture among students.

4.1.3 Perceived Effectiveness of Entrepreneurship Education

Table 9
Perceived Effectiveness of Entrepreneurship Education

Learning Outcome	Mean
The courses and events I attended increased my understanding of the attitudes, values, and motivations of entrepreneurs. (3.10)	*5.16*
The courses and events I attended increased my understanding of the actions someone has to take to start a business. (3.11)	*5.20*
The courses and events I attended enhanced my practical management skills to start a business. (3.12)	*5.04*
The courses and events I attended enhanced my ability to develop networks.(3.13)	*5.13*

Respondents reported that entrepreneurship courses and events significantly enhanced their understanding of entrepreneurial attitudes, values, and motivations (M = 5.16)

and improved their grasp of the actions required to start a business (M = 5.20)—the highest mean among the four items. They also agreed that these experiences strengthened their practical management skills (M = 5.04) and ability to build networks (M = 5.13).

Students rate the courses and events they attended above 5.0 on all four learning outcomes (5.04–5.20 on the 7-point scale). These are perception measures: they show how students assess their courses, not measured changes in skill. Moderate variability in responses points to differences in program quality across institutions. Strengthening experiential components—such as mentorships, incubators, and industry partnerships—can further enhance the real-world relevance of entrepreneurship education.

4.2 Family Background

4.2.1 Parental Entrepreneurship

Table 10
Parental Entrepreneurship

Parental Entrepreneurship Status	n	% age
Neither parent is a business owner	*430*	*64.3%*
Both parents are business owners	*102*	*15.2%*
Father only is a business owner	*73*	*10.9%*
Mother only is a business owner	*64*	*9.6%*

Among the 669 respondents, **64.3%** reported that neither parent owns or manages a business, showing that most students come from non-entrepreneurial households. Meanwhile, **10.9%** said only their father is self-employed or a business owner, **9.6%** said the same about their mother, and **15.2%** indicated that both parents are entrepreneurs.

Overall, about one-third of students have at least one entrepreneurial parent, with dual-entrepreneur households forming the largest entrepreneurial subgroup. This pattern suggests that while familial exposure to entrepreneurship is limited, it remains a meaningful influence—providing role models that may shape students' entrepreneurial attitudes and aspirations through early observation and experience.

4.2.2 Entrepreneurial Network

Table 11
Entrepreneurial Network

Network Connection	% Full Sample	% Active Founders
Siblings / other relatives	*46.0%*	*60.0%*

Network Connection	% Full Sample	% Active Founders
Friends	*28.0%*	*47.3%*
Peers / classmates	*27.4%*	*41.8%*
Other important people	*22.6%*	*27.3%*
University professors / mentors	*18.7%*	*27.3%*
No one in network is an entrepreneur	*30.0%*	*16.4%*

Students were asked whether they had entrepreneurs within their personal networks beyond their parents. Results show that **46%** have siblings or other relatives who run businesses—the most common source of entrepreneurial influence—followed by friends (**28%**), peers or classmates (**27.4%**), other important people (**22.6%**), and university professors or mentors (**18.7%**). Meanwhile, **30%** of the full sample reported having no entrepreneurs in their network, compared to only **16.4%** among active founders.

These findings indicate that entrepreneurial exposure is strongest within family and social circles, while institutional connections play a smaller role. Active founders tend to be more embedded in entrepreneurial networks, suggesting that peer and relational influences contribute significantly to entrepreneurial engagement.

The pattern potentially highlights the need for universities to strengthen ecosystem-building initiatives such as mentorship programs, alumni networking, and peer entrepreneurship communities. Expanding these institutional networks can help bridge gaps in family-based exposure, fostering collaboration and experiential learning that encourage students to transform entrepreneurial interest into action.

4.2.3 Patterns of Entrepreneurial Orientation Among Sampled Philippine University Students

Table 12
Entrepreneurial Orientation Dimensions

EO Dimension	Mean	Rank
Proactiveness	5.10	*#1*
Autonomy	4.96	*#2*
Innovativeness	4.77	*#3*
Risk-Taking	4.74	*#4*
Competitive Aggressiveness	4.66	*#5*

The **Entrepreneurial Orientation (EO)** scale measures five behavioral dimensions—**Autonomy, Competitive Aggressiveness, Innovativeness, Proactiveness, and Risk-Taking**—using statements rated from 1 (*strongly disagree*) to 7 (*strongly agree*). These items capture how individuals identify with entrepreneurial traits and behaviors (Clark et al., 2025).

Sample Statements per EO Dimension

- *Autonomy: "I act with great autonomy when choosing life paths or opportunities to pursue."*
- *Competitive Aggressiveness: "I typically respond vigorously to competitive assaults or challenges by others."*
- *Innovativeness: "I experiment with novel, innovative behavior regardless of established approaches."*
- *Proactiveness: "I often act in advance of others when responding to opportunities and threats."*
- *Risk-Taking: "I prefer high-risk/high-reward opportunities over low-risk/low-reward opportunities."*

The results show that Proactiveness ranks highest (M = 5.10), followed by Autonomy (M = 4.96), Innovativeness (M = 4.77), Risk-Taking (M = 4.74), and Competitive Aggressiveness (M = 4.66). These findings suggest that university students are opportunity-driven and future-oriented, actively anticipating and responding to emerging trends while maintaining a balanced approach to uncertainty.

The spread across the five dimensions is small: 0.44 points on the 7-point scale, from competitive aggressiveness (4.66) to proactiveness (5.10). The comparatively lower scores for Competitive Aggressiveness and Risk-Taking may reflect cultural values such as *pakikisama* (social harmony), *hiya* (modesty), and *utang na loob* (reciprocal obligation), which temper confrontation and high-risk behavior. These values encourage collaboration, prudence, and ethical conduct, shaping a relational approach to entrepreneurship that prioritizes trust and long-term relationships over short-term competition. Further studies can explore this cultural dimension.

4.2.4 Entrepreneurial Intention and Entrepreneurial Action Orientation

When asked whether they owned or managed a business with regular sales in the past three months, or were creating one that had not yet generated sales, **531 respondents (79.4%)** fell into the GUESSS category of **"Not Nascent and Not Active."**

For this majority, strong interest and positive attitudes toward entrepreneurship have not yet translated into actual business creation or management — an intention-action gap. Possible barriers include **limited resources, risk aversion, academic priorities, and cultural expectations** favoring stable employment.

To bridge this intention–action divide, universities should implement **action-oriented programs** such as incubation hubs, seed funding, and experiential courses that build confidence and capability. For policymakers and educators, this gap underscores the need to evolve entrepreneurship education beyond theory—toward **hands-on engagement, mentorship, and prototype development**—to transform aspiration into measurable economic participation and foster a more dynamic, innovation-driven youth sector.

4.2.5 Preferred Economic Sector

Table 13
Preferred Economic Sector

Economic Sector	Description	% of Respondents	Rank
Yellow Economy	Information technology, artificial intelligence, digitalization	32.7	#1
Other	Diverse or hybrid fields (e.g., sustainability consulting, ed-tech, creative entrepreneurship)	24.0	#2
Orange Economy	Arts, music, fashion, design	9.7	#3
Red Economy	Factories, construction, manufacturing	8.7	#4
White Economy	Pharmaceuticals, hospitals, healthcare	7.6	#5
Social & Solidarity Economy	Social enterprises, NGOs, community-based ventures	7.4	#6
Green Economy	Environmental sustainability, renewable energy, eco-innovation	4.8	#7
Blue Economy	Marine resources, fisheries, ocean-based industries	<3	#8
Brown Economy	Mining, heavy industry, fossil fuels	<3	#9
Rural Economy	Agriculture, agribusiness, rural development	<3	#10
Silver Economy	Elderly care, age-related services	<3	#11

Among the 526 respondents who answered (those neither active nor nascent), the Yellow Economy—covering information technology, artificial intelligence, and digitalization—was the most preferred career sector (**32.7%**). This strong inclination toward technology-driven industries reflects the growing appeal of innovation and digital

transformation among the respondents. The Orange Economy (arts, music, fashion, design) ranked second (**9.7%**) among named sectors, followed by the Red Economy (factories, construction, **8.7%**) and White Economy (pharmaceuticals, hospitals, **7.6%**). Moderate interest was shown in the Social and Solidarity Economy (**7.4%**) and Green Economy (**4.8%**), while traditional sectors such as Blue, Brown, Rural, and Silver Economies each drew less than **3%**. Notably, **24%** selected “Other,” signaling diverse aspirations beyond predefined categories.

Overall, respondents favored innovation-oriented and creative sectors, suggesting that the sampled university students associate career success with scalability, creativity, and global relevance. The prominence of the Yellow and Orange Economies points to a future shaped by digital entrepreneurship and cultural production, where technology and artistry converge. Universities and policymakers can harness this momentum through programs in technology incubation, creative enterprise development, and sustainability-focused entrepreneurship, fostering interdisciplinary collaboration and preparing students for a dynamic, innovation-driven economy.

5. Active Entrepreneurs

Active entrepreneurs or founders are students who currently own and manage a business that has generated regular sales over the last three months This group comprises 55 respondents, or **8.2%** of the full sample.

5.1 Descriptive Profile

Table 14
Key Descriptive Profiles of Active Entrepreneurs

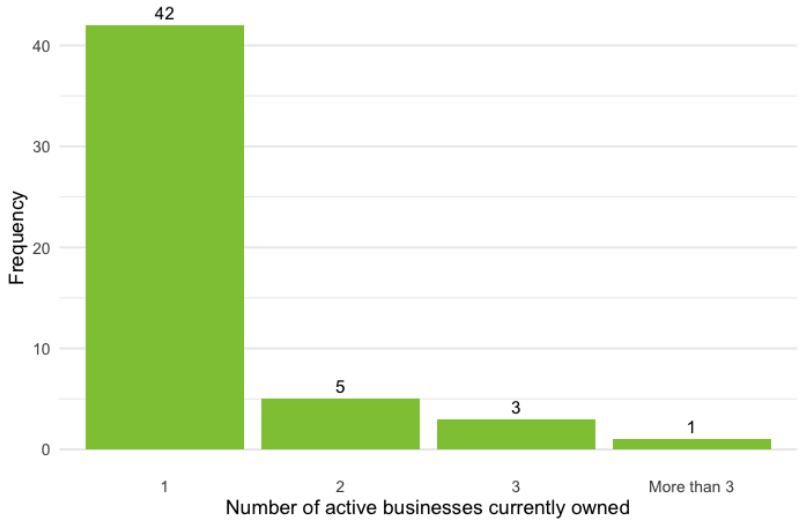
Characteristic	Value
Number of active entrepreneurs	*n=55*
Gender: Male	*54.5%*
Gender: Female	*45.5%*
Study level: Undergraduate	*94.5%*
Field: Business/Management	*43.6%*
Field: Engineering	*14.5%*
Field: Computer Sciences	*10.9%*
Parental Entrepreneurship (both parents)	*32.7%*
Parental Entrepreneurship (neither)	*36.4%*

Among the 55 active entrepreneurs (**8.2%** of the full sample), the majority are undergraduate students (**94.5%**) and predominantly male (**54.5%**). Nearly half specialize in business or management, followed by engineering and computer sciences, indicating a strong technical and managerial foundation among student founders. Roughly one-third have entrepreneurial parents, suggesting that family exposure plays a notable role in shaping entrepreneurial engagement. Overall, this profile reflects a young, academically diverse group of entrepreneurs with both managerial and technical competencies—an encouraging sign for the development of innovation-driven ventures in the sampled student population.

5.2 Number of Businesses Currently Owned and Managed

Figure 1

Frequency of Total Owned and Managed Businesses of Active Entrepreneurs

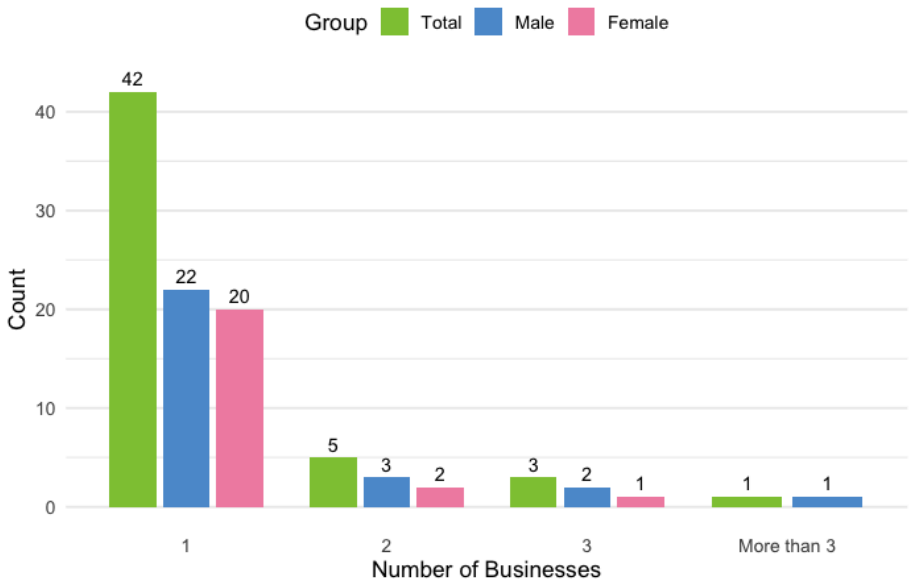


Among the 55 active student entrepreneurs, 42 of 51 valid responses (**82.4%**) manage **one business**, confirming that single-venture ownership dominates. Five respondents (**9.8%**) operate two businesses, three **(5.9%)** manage three businesses, and one **(2.0%)** oversee more than three—showing a sharp decline as ventures increase. This pattern reflects a preference to focus on one enterprise by this sample.

By gender, **22 males and 20 females** manage a single business, while males slightly outnumber females at the two-business level (3 vs. 2). However, small sample sizes warrant cautious interpretation.

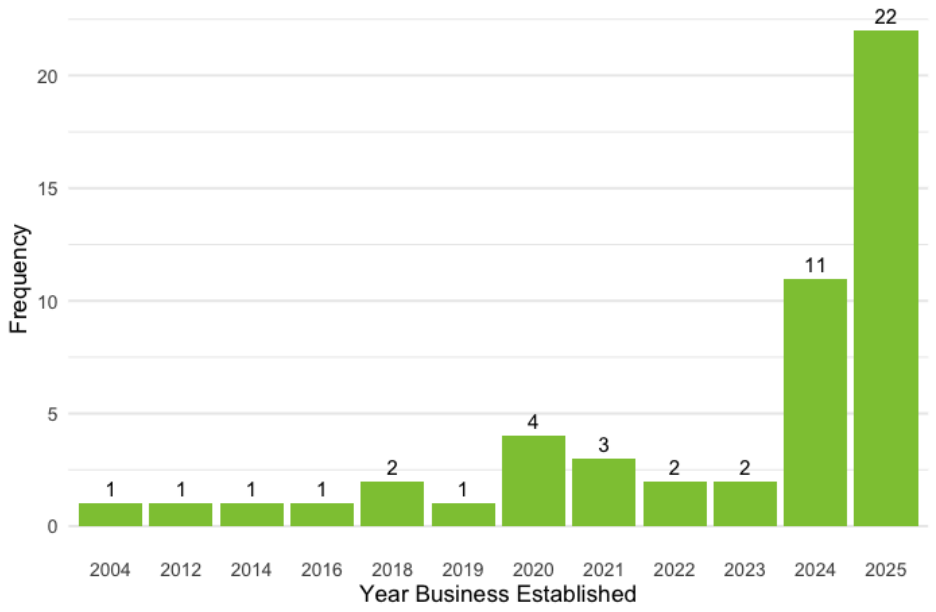
Figure 2

Number of Businesses Owned and Managed by Active Entrepreneurs by Gender



5.3 Year Business was Established

Figure 3
Businesses Created by Active Entrepreneurs by Year



Most active student entrepreneurs started their business in **2024 or 2025**. 2025 has the highest number, with 22 businesses. The age of the founders range from 18-26 indicating that these businesses were likely established while the founders are still currently students.

5.4 On formalizing the Business

Figure 4
Share of Businesses of Active Entrepreneurs by Formal Registration

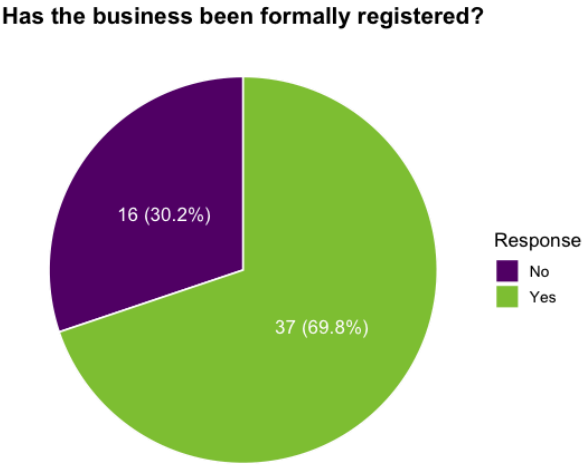


Figure 4 shows that a substantial majority of active student entrepreneurs— 37of 53 (**69.8%**)—have formally registered their businesses, while 16 (**30.2%**) remain unregistered. Business registration and other government compliance requirements are usually cumbersome processes in the Philippines and further investigation can be done on the effect of either easing this or providing regulatory support on student entrepreneurship.

Figure 5

Number of Full Time Employees the Businesses of Active Entrepreneurs Have

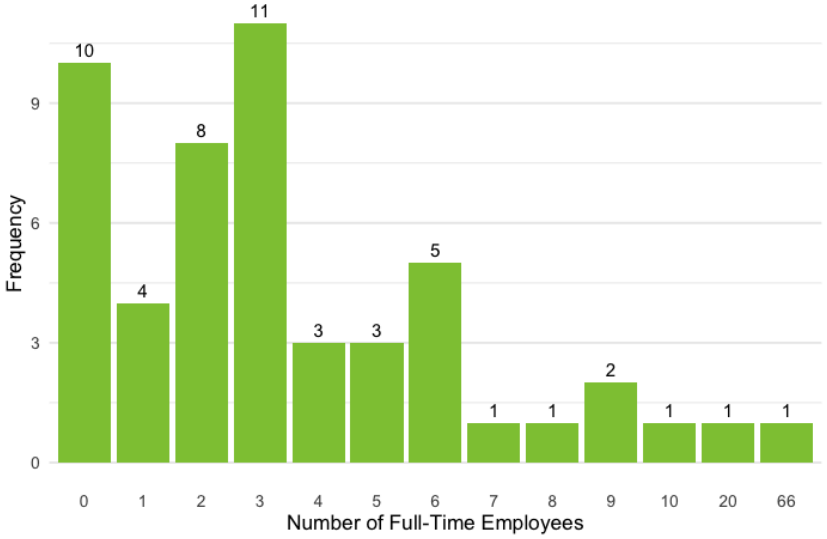


Figure 5 reveals that most student-run businesses in this sample are micro-enterprises, typically employing 0 to 3 full-time equivalents. The highest frequencies occur at 3 employees (around 11 businesses) and 0 employees (around 10 businesses), indicating that many ventures are either solo operations or small teams. This pattern is consistent with early-stage entrepreneurship, where founders rely on personal effort and limited resources. The small workforce size also reflects the nature of student ventures—often service-oriented, digital, or project-based—requiring minimal staffing.

Figure 6

Ownership Share of Active Entrepreneurs

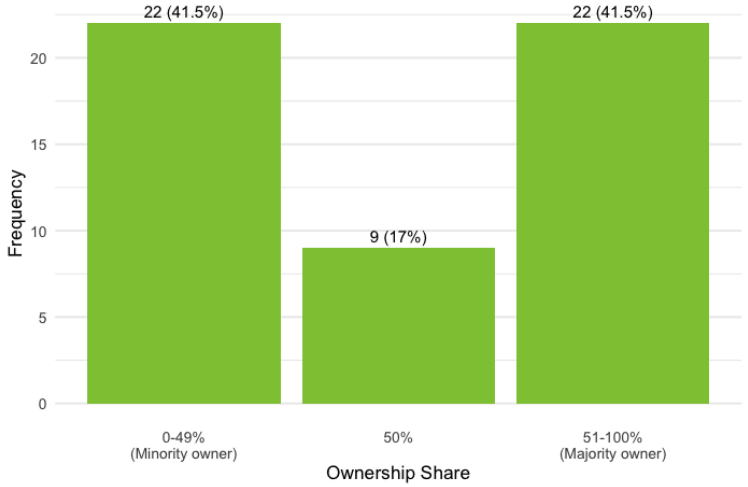
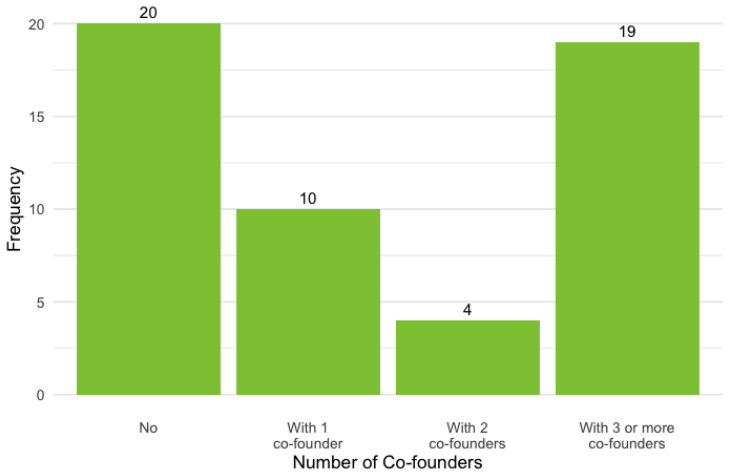


Figure 6 shows that ownership is evenly split between minority (**0–49%**) and majority (**51–100%**) owners, each accounting for roughly 22–23 respondents, while equal (**50%**) ownership is less common (around 9 respondents). This distribution suggests diverse ownership structures among the sampled student entrepreneurs, with many either holding controlling stakes or participating in shared ventures. The balance between minority and majority ownership may reflect collaborative startup models, where students pool resources and expertise while maintaining flexible equity arrangements.

Figure 7

Number of Co-Founders the Business of Active Entrepreneurs Have

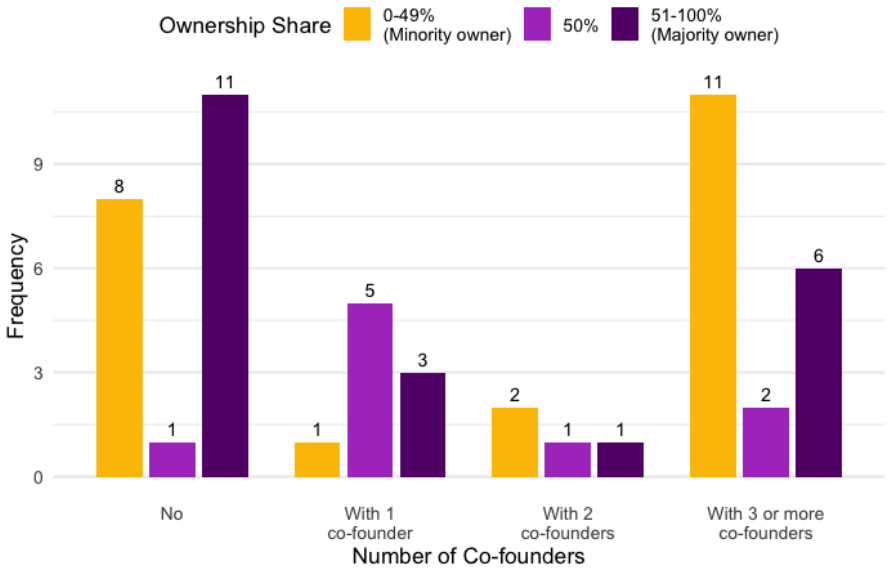


Finally, Figure 7 indicates that entrepreneurial collaboration is polarized for this sample: 20 respondents started their businesses alone, while another 20 did so with three or more co-founders. Fewer respondents reported having one (≈10) or two (≈5) co-founders. This dual pattern suggests two dominant entrepreneurial approaches—independent ventures driven by autonomy and personal vision, and team-based startups leveraging collective creativity and shared risk.

5.5 Co-Founders by Ownership Share

Figure 8

Number of Co-Founders by Ownership Share (Active Entrepreneurs)



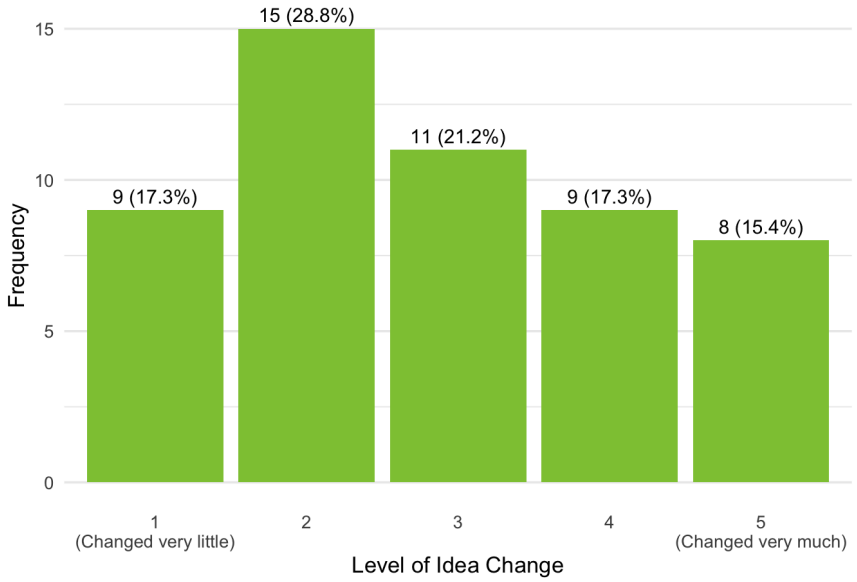
The combined distribution of co-founders and ownership shares reveals distinct patterns in how equity is allocated across varying founding structures in the sample. Among solo founders, most hold majority stakes (11), another group (8) hold minority stakes and one reports an equal **50%** share indicating that even individual founders may share equity with

external investors, partners, or family members. For ventures with one co-founder, equal ownership predominates (5 respondents), reflecting the common practice of 50–50 splits in two-founder teams. In startups with three or more co-founders, minority ownership becomes more frequent (11 respondents), suggesting that equity is distributed more broadly across larger founding teams, thereby reducing individual shares. Currently, there is a knowledge gap on the founding structures of startups and this can be an area of further exploration.

5.6 Degree of Change in Business Idea

Figure 9

Extent of Change in Business Idea Since Conception

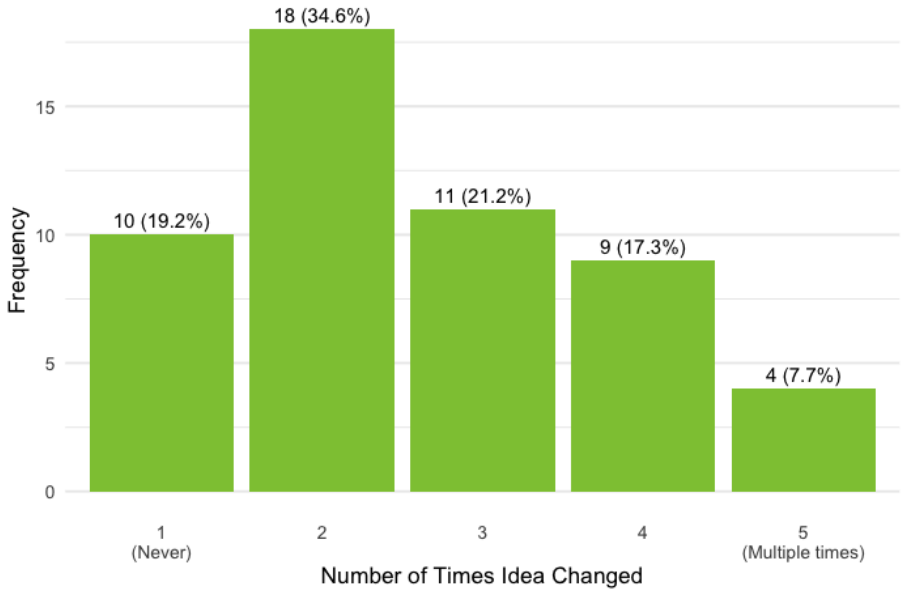


The distribution of responses indicates that most student entrepreneurs in this sample experienced moderate evolution in their business ideas. The highest frequencies at “2” and “3” suggest that while ideas changed somewhat, they did not undergo drastic transformation. Only a few respondents selected “5” (changed very much), implying that most founders refined and adjusted their concepts without abandoning their original vision. This moderate level of change aligns with early-stage entrepreneurial behavior, where founders iterate based on feedback, feasibility, and resource constraints but have yet to implement major strategic pivots. Overall, the pattern reflects a pragmatic approach to innovation—student entrepreneurs in the sample are learning to adapt and improve their ideas incrementally while preserving the core essence of their initial concept.

5.7 Frequency of Pivoting

Figure 10

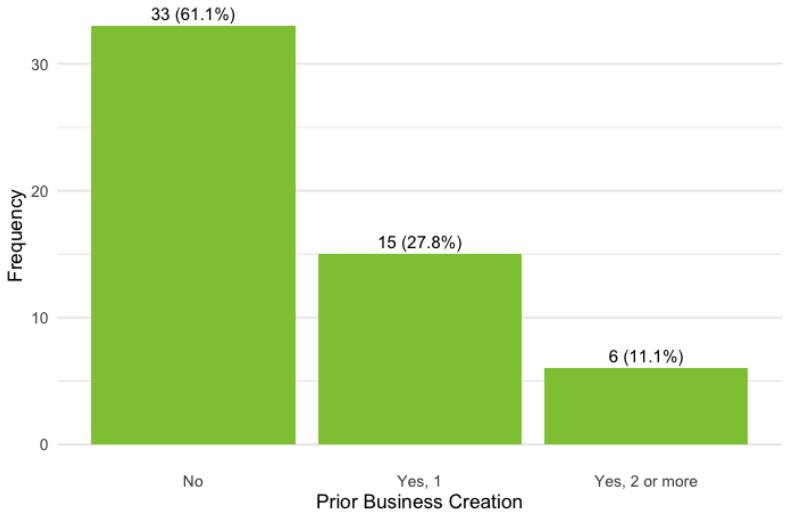
Frequency of Business Idea Pivots



Responses on the 1-5 pivot-frequency scale (1 = never, 5 = multiple times) cluster toward the lower-middle range: 10 respondents selected 1 (never), 18 selected 2, 11 selected 3, 9 selected 4, and 4 selected 5 (multiple times). Most active entrepreneurs in this sample therefore report some iterative refinement of their idea rather than either rigidity or constant reinvention consistent with the early stages of venture formation, where founders adjust based on feedback, feasibility, and resource constraints.

5.8 Prior Business Creation

Figure 11
Number of Previously Created (Inactive) Businesses Among Active Entrepreneurs



The final figure shows that most active entrepreneurs (33) have not previously created another business, while 15 have created one and 6 have launched two or more inactive ventures. This indicates that the majority are first-time founders, consistent with their young age and early career stage. Overall, most of the 55 active entrepreneurs operate small, recently established ventures: a majority have registered their business (37 of 53 valid responses, **69.8%**), most employ between 0 and 3 full-time staff, and founding structures divide between solo founders (20) and teams of three or more co-founders (19). Because this subsample is small (n = 55), further exploration should be done to determine if patterns that can be inferred from this describe only this group or if it can be extended to Philippine university student entrepreneurs in general.

5.9 Dynamic Capabilities

Table 15
Active Entrepreneur Profile

Question	Mean	SD
Understanding the resource and capability needs of my business	*5.33*	*1.20*
Identifying specific resources and capabilities supportive of my business	*5.47*	*1.20*
Envisioning the overall resource and capability profile of my business	*5.35*	*1.24*
Conceptualizing how resources and capabilities should work together	*5.62*	*1.19*
Developing essential resources and capabilities within my business	*5.29*	*1.27*
Procuring resources and capabilities from external sources when necessary	*5.27*	*1.34*
Accessing resources through internal development or procurement	*5.18*	*1.39*

Question	Mean	SD
Ensuring that essential resources and capabilities are under my control	*5.30*	*1.27*
Orchestrating the deployment of resources within my business	*5.42*	*1.17*
Reconfiguring resource deployment or allocation when needed	*5.31*	*1.15*
Integrating or co-aligning resources and capabilities that need to be linked	*5.39*	*1.12*
Designing coordinating structures and processes that guide resource allocation	*5.24*	*1.26*

Findings on dynamic capabilities—defined as the ability to sense, seize, and transform resources—reveal how active student entrepreneurs (n = 55) manage their ventures. With mean scores between 5.3 and 5.6 on a 7-point scale, they show strong confidence in strategic alignment and resource management. Their key strengths lie in conceptualizing how resources and capabilities should work together (M = 5.62) and orchestrating their use (M = 5.42), reflecting effective internal governance and asset utilization. However, lower scores in external resource acquisition (M = 5.27) and formal coordination design (M = 5.24) indicate challenges in scaling and institutionalization. Overall, these student entrepreneurs are strategically aware and proactive but constrained by structural limits. Future support focusing on strengthening external engagement and building scalable organizational frameworks can be potentially considered by universities.

5.10 Unethical Pro-Organization Behaviour

This section explores entrepreneurs' ethical decision-making when organizational benefit conflicts with moral standards. Mean scores across the six items range from 2.83 to 3.42 on the 7-point scale, all below the midpoint, indicating that, on average, the sampled active student entrepreneurs generally reject unethical actions even when these could advance their business interests.

Between **52%** and **62%** of respondents rated each item in the 1–3 range, while **27%** to **37%** expressed some agreement (ratings 5-7), a sizable minority. Willingness was highest for concealing damaging information from the public (M = 3.42). Valid responses covered about **96%** of the active-entrepreneur subsample (n = 54).

Table 16
Unethical Pro-organization Behaviour

Statement	Mean Score
If it would help my business, I would misrepresent the truth to make it look good.	*3.08*

Statement	Mean Score
If it would help my business, I would exaggerate the truth about its products or services to customers and clients.	*3.21*
If it would help my business, I would withhold negative information about its products or services from customers and clients.	*3.09*
If it would help my business, I would give a good recommendation on behalf of an incompetent employee in the hope that the person will become another business' problem.	*2.83*
If it would help my business, I would withhold issuing a refund to a customer or client accidentally overcharged.	*2.94*
If it would help my business, I would conceal information from the public that could be damaging to my business.	*3.42*

The results in Table 16 indicate ethical restraint on average, but not uniformly: roughly three in ten active entrepreneurs expressed some willingness toward at least one unethical pro-organizational behavior. Ethics modules within entrepreneurship education remain relevant especially if this trend can be observed in a larger population.

5.11 Performance Dimension (vs. Competitors)

Table 17
Performance Dimension (Vs. Competitors)

Dimension	Mean Score	Rank
Market share growth	*4.81*	*Highest*
Sales growth	*4.79*	
Profit growth	*4.79*	
Innovativeness	*4.79*	
Job creation	*4.43*	*Lowest*

This section evaluates the performance of sampled student-led ventures across five dimensions relative to competitors. Respondents reported generally positive outcomes, with mean scores between 4.43 and 4.81 on a 7-point scale. Market share growth ranked highest (M = 4.81), followed by sales, profit, and innovativeness (all M = 4.79), while job creation scored lowest (M = 4.43). These results indicate strong competitiveness in market and revenue metrics but modest capacity for workforce expansion. High ratings in market growth and innovativeness reflect a lean, efficiency-driven mindset, whereas lower job creation underscores the early-stage nature of these micro-enterprises. Thus, the sampled student entrepreneurs are performance-oriented yet constrained by scaling limitations. Strengthening

access to growth resources and employment incentives will be key to transforming these ventures into sustainable contributors to national job creation.

5.12 Social and Environmental Performance Perception

Table 18

Mean Scores for CSR Orientation Among Student Entrepreneurs

Statement	Mean Score
Contributes to campaigns promoting societal well-being	*4.87*
Targets sustainable growth considering future generations	*4.83*
Emphasizes importance of social responsibilities	*4.83*
Participates in environmental protection activities	*4.74*

Active entrepreneurial students were asked how they perceive their ventures' commitment to social and environmental responsibility. Respondents expressed moderate-to-high agreement across all indicators, with mean scores ranging from 4.74 to 4.87 on a 7-point scale, reflecting a strong sense of ethical awareness and civic engagement. Contributing to campaigns that promote societal well-being received the highest rating (M = 4.87), underscoring active participation in community-oriented initiatives. Equally high scores for sustainable growth and social responsibility (both M = 4.83) reveal a balanced dedication to long-term development and ethical business conduct. Although participation in environmental protection activities scored slightly lower (M = 4.74), it still indicates meaningful involvement and highlights potential for deeper engagement in ecological programs.

6. Nascent Entrepreneurs

Nascent entrepreneurs are defined as students who are currently in the process of establishing a business that has not yet generated regular sales (Q2.12 = “Yes”). This group consists of 103 respondents (*n* = 103), representing **15.4%** of the total sample.

6.1 General Information

Table 19
Plans to Complete Founding of Nascent Business

When do you plan to complete the founding process?	Count (n)	Share (%)
During my studies	*39*	*37.8*
After my studies	*48*	*46.6*
Do not know yet	*15*	*14.5*
Did not answer	*1*	*1.1*

Table 20
Share of Registered Business Idea for Nascent Entrepreneurs

Registration Status: Already registered?	Count (n)	Share (%)
Yes	*28*	*27.2*
No	*73*	*70.8*
Did not answer	*3*	*2.0*

Table 21
Business Ownership Share of Nascent Business

Approximate Ownership Share	Count (n)	Share (%)
0-49%	*23*	*22.8*
50%	*29*	*28.7*
51-100%	*49*	*48.5*
Did not answer	*2*	*1.9*

Table 22

Founding Team Structure of Nascent Businesses

Founding Team Structure	Count (n)	Share (%)
Solo founder (no co-founders)	*53*	*51.5*
With 1 co-founder	*17*	*16.5*
With 2 co-founders	*14*	*13.6*
With 3 or more co-founders	*17*	*16.5*
Did not answer	*2*	*1.9*

Table 23

Planned Economic Sector for Nascent Business

Planned Economic Sector	Count (n)	Share (%)
Other (retail, personal services, etc.)	*39*	*38.6*
Orange Economy (arts, music, fashion, design)	*25*	*24.8*
Yellow Economy (IT, AI, digitalization)	*14*	*13.9*
Rural economy (agriculture)	*6*	*5.9*
Green Economy (renewable energy)	*5*	*5*
Social and solidarity economy	*4*	*4*
Blue Economy (e.g. fisheries, marine tourism)	*3*	*3*
Brown Economy (e.g., non-renewable energy)	*0*	*0*
Red Economy	*2*	*2*
Silver Economy	*0*	*0*
White Economy	*3*	*3*

The profile of nascent entrepreneurs reveals a diverse yet distinctly early-stage entrepreneurial landscape among the sampled Philippine students. Most respondents are still developing their ventures, characterized by limited formal registration and small founding teams. The prevalence of solo founders and majority ownership underscores strong individual initiative but also hints at challenges in collaboration and resource pooling. A significant portion plan to complete their business founding process after graduation (**46.6%**), while **37.8%** intend to do so during their studies, and **14.5%** remain uncertain. Nearly three-fourths have not yet registered their ventures (**70.8%**), confirming that most remain in the conceptual or pre-operational stage.

Sectoral distribution shows concentration in retail and personal services (**38.6%**), followed by the Orange Economy—arts, music, fashion, and design (**24.8%**)—and the Yellow Economy—IT, AI, and digitalization (**13.9%**). These sectors reflect accessible markets and low entry barriers suited to student-led ventures. The relatively low participation in green, social, and rural economies points to opportunities for universities and policymakers to promote entrepreneurship in sustainability-oriented fields. Overall, nascent entrepreneurs in this sample exhibit ambition, independence, and creativity. Mentorship, incubation programs, and access to funding could help these students move from concept to operating business (see Section 9.8).

6.2 Experience in Creating a Business Venture

The table below presents the responses of nascent entrepreneurs when asked: "*Have you created another business before this one that is not active anymore?"*

Table 24
On Previous Founding Experience of Nascent Entrepreneurs (Business Not Active Anymore)

Response	Count (n)	Share (%)
No	*51*	*49.5*
Yes, 1	*27*	*26.2*
Yes, 2 or more	*5*	*4.9*
Did not answer	*20*	*19.4*

The profile of prior business creation reveals a predominantly first-time entrepreneurial population. Of the 83 nascent entrepreneurs asked (20 respondents did not encounter the question as they are also active entrepreneurs), **49.5%** (n=51) have not previously created another business, **26.2%** (n=27) reported one prior venture that has since ceased operations, and **4.9%** (n=5) have launched two or more inactive businesses. If this is a trend that can be extended to the wider Philippine student entrepreneurial landscape, there would be a need for foundational support systems such as mentorship, entrepreneurship education, and early-stage funding to help first-time founders overcome startup challenges. At the same time, students with prior founding experience are a resource for peer learning. Programs that pair them with first-time founders are an easily attainable support option that universities can explore.

6.3 Perceptions of the Business Environment

Nascent entrepreneurs who are not also active entrepreneurs (n=83) were asked to indicate their level of agreement (1 = strongly disagree, 7 = strongly agree) with statements assessing the institutional and structural support available to student entrepreneurs in their region. The results reveal that respondents agree that *taking loans from banks is quite difficult* (M = 5.33), identifying financial access as the most significant structural barrier. This finding aligns with previous studies emphasizing limited financing options as a persistent challenge for young entrepreneurs (Turker & Selcuk, 2009).

Table 25
Perception of Business Environment of Nascent Entrepreneurs

Ecosystem Dimension	Mean
Taking Loans from banks is quite difficult for student entrepreneurs	*5.33*
Student entrepreneurs are encouraged by a structural system including private, public, and non-governmental organizations.	*5.16*
state laws (rules and regulations) are adverse to student entrepreneurs.	*4.87*
The economy provides many opportunities for student entrepreneurs.	*4.86*

Respondents also expressed moderate agreement that *student entrepreneurs are encouraged by a structural system including private, public, and non-governmental organizations* (M = 5.16), suggesting that institutional support structures are present but may not be fully optimized or accessible. Meanwhile, perceptions that *state laws are adverse to student entrepreneurs* (M = 4.87) and that *the economy provides many opportunities* (M = 4.86) indicate a mixed outlook—student entrepreneurs of this sample recognize opportunities but remain constrained by regulatory and financial hurdles.

6.4 Entrepreneurial Actions Undertaken by Nascent Founders

Respondents were asked which activities they or their founding team had already undertaken to create their business. The results reveal varying degrees of engagement across the entrepreneurial process, reflecting a progression from idea validation to formalization.

Table 26
Nascent-Founder Activities

Activity	Count (n)	% of Nascent Founders (True)
Discussed product or business idea with potential customers	*50*	*60.2*
Collected information about markets or competitors	*41*	*49.4*

Activity	Count (n)	% of Nascent Founders (True)
Written a business plan	*38*	*45.8*
Started product/service development	*31*	*37.3*
Started marketing or promotion efforts	*22*	*26.5*
Purchased material, equipment, or machinery	*24*	*28.9*
Sold a product or service	*26*	*31.3*
Attempted to obtain external funding	*11*	*13.3*
Registered the business	*7*	*8.4*
Applied for intellectual property (patent, copyright, trademark)	*5*	*6.0*
None of the above	*13*	*15.7*

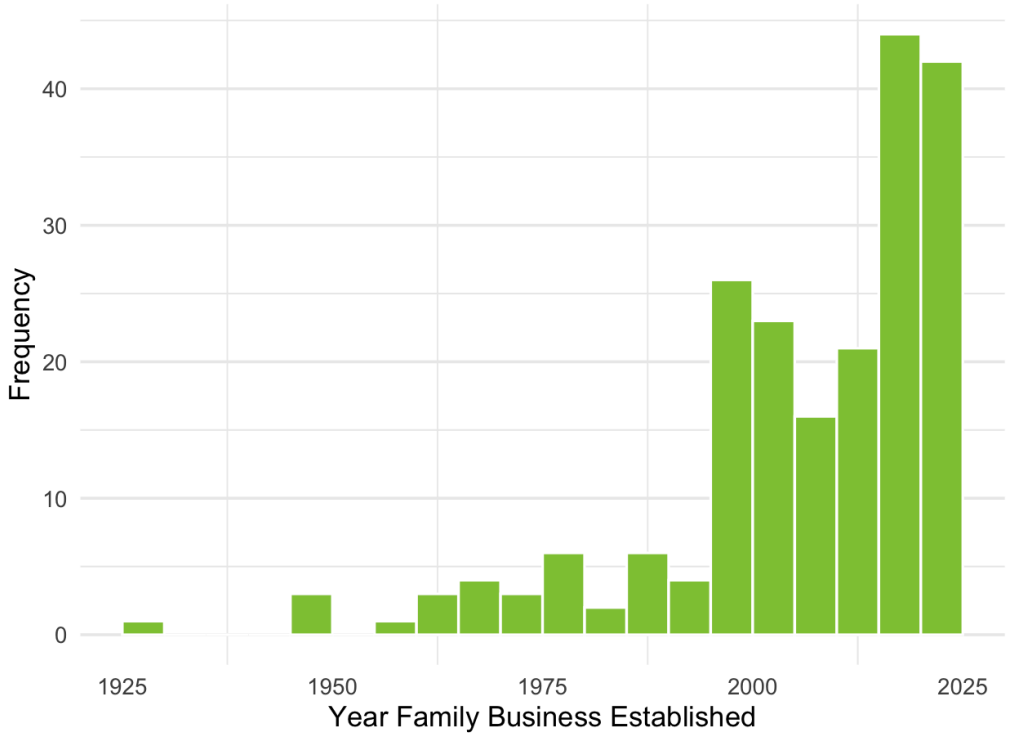
The data show that early-stage validation activities—such as discussing ideas with potential customers (**60.2 %**) and collecting market or competitor information (**49.4 %**)—are the most common. In contrast, formalization activities like business registration (**8.4 %**) and intellectual property application (**6.0 %**) are rare. This pattern suggests that most of the sampled student entrepreneurs remain in the pre-validation or conceptual phase, focusing on idea testing and market understanding rather than formal establishment.

Moderate engagement in writing business plans (**45.8 %**) and product/service development (**37.3 %**) indicates a transition toward structured planning and implementation. However, limited participation in external funding attempts (**13.3 %**) and marketing efforts (**26.5 %**) underscores the financial and promotional constraints faced by nascent entrepreneurs.Overall, the activity profile reveals a funnel gap—a high concentration of pre-validation actions but minimal formalization—characteristic of pre-seed entrepreneurial behavior.

7. Your Parents' / Family Business

7.1 General information

Figure 12
Distribution of Family Business Founding Years



Of the 239 eligible respondents, roughly 10 entries were invalid and excluded, and 25 left the item blank, leaving about 204 valid responses. The 25 blank responses were likely because they were unsure of their family business's founding year. The average founding year was 2006.98 (SD = 17.315), meaning most family enterprises began around 2007. The distribution is concentrated between 1990 and 2010, indicating that the average respondents come from families with relatively young, first-generation businesses.

7.2 Distribution of Total Number of Employees

The figure below shows the total number of employees (full-time equivalents) reported for the family businesses.

Figure 13
Distribution of Total Number of Employees (Full-Time Equivalents)

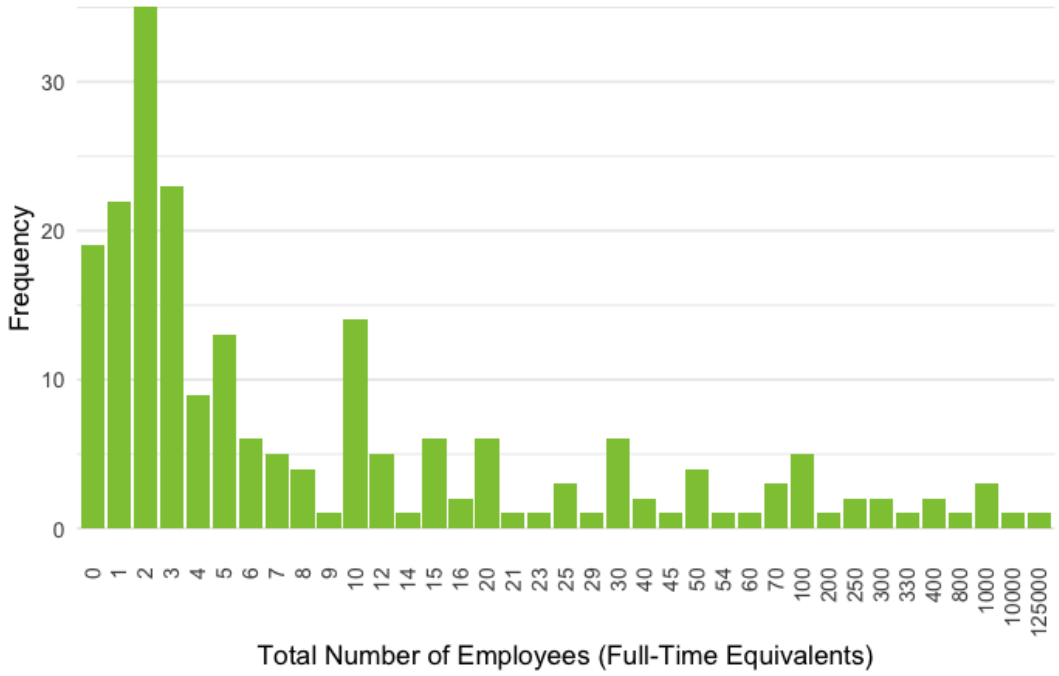


Figure 13 presents the results of the total number of employees (full-time equivalents) in the family businesses. Half of the businesses report between zero and four full-time employees, with the highest frequency at around two employees. As the number of employees increases, the frequency of responses declines.A few businesses report much larger workforces. The most extreme entries (several hundred to six figures) likely include reporting errors and should be interpreted with caution. Overall, the data reflect a predominance of micro- to small-sized family-run businesses within the sampled group.

7.3 Extent of Parental Ownership in Family Enterprises

Figure 14

Ownership Share Held by Parents in Parents' Business

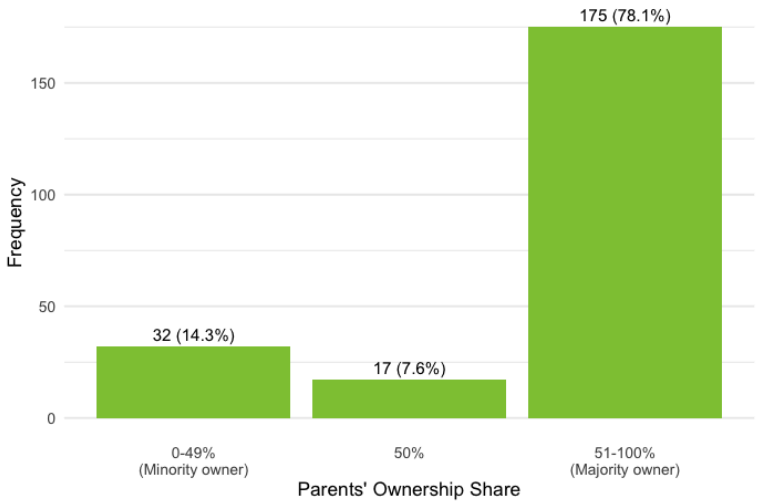


Figure 14 illustrates the distribution of ownership shares held by respondents' parents in their family businesses. Most parents are majority owners, holding **51–100%** of the business (175 respondents, **78.1%** valid). A smaller group hold minority shares (**0–49%**; 32 respondents, **14.3%** valid), while 17 respondents (**7.6%** valid) reported equal ownership at **50%**. In total, 224 valid responses were recorded, with 15 missing—likely due to uncertainty about ownership details.

This pattern shows that family businesses in the sample are largely parent-controlled, with decision-making and management concentrated among one or both parents. The limited number of minority or equal-share arrangements reflects traditional family business structures in the Philippines, where authority and ownership are typically centralized within the parental generation.

7.4 Number of Older Siblings

Figure 15
Number of Older Siblings for Business Successors

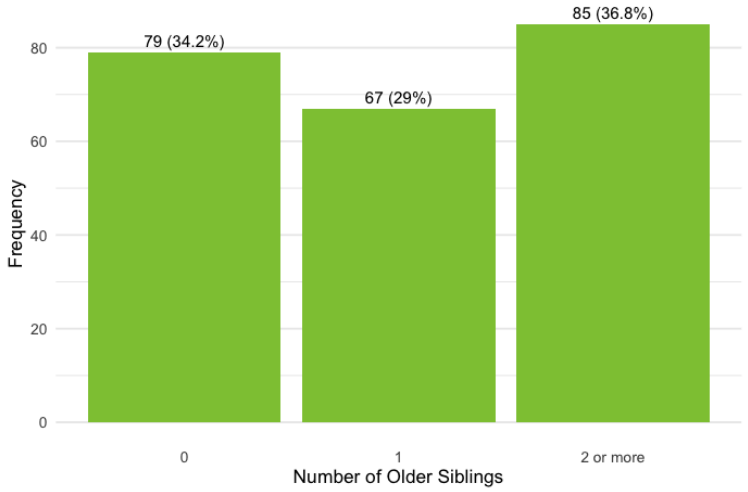
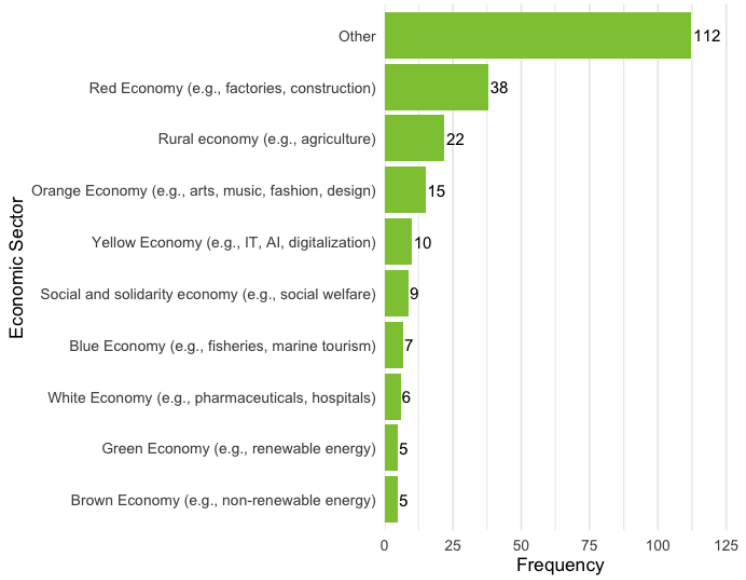


Figure 15 shows the distribution of respondents based on the number of older siblings. Three groups emerge: those with no older siblings (about 80 respondents), one older sibling (around 70), and two or more older siblings (about 90). The largest group consists of respondents with multiple older siblings, indicating that many come from families where they are not the eldest child. This pattern in the sample may influence family business succession, as birth order often shapes expectations around leadership, inheritance, and involvement in family enterprises. Families with several older siblings may face more complex succession decisions, with responsibilities and ownership potentially shared among multiple heirs.

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7.5 Economic Sector of Parents' Business

Figure 16
Economies of Family Business



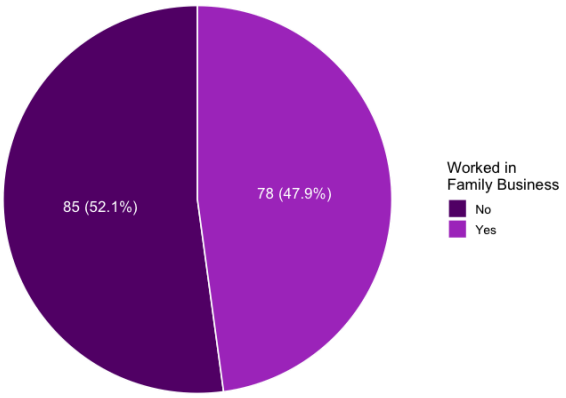
The figure above summarizes the economic sectors in which respondents' parents' businesses are primarily active. The results show substantial variation across sectors, with the **Red Economy** (e.g., factories, construction) being the most represented, accounting for **38 respondents (16.6% valid)**. This is followed by the **Rural Economy** (agriculture) with **22 respondents (9.6% valid)** and the **Orange Economy** (arts, music, fashion, design) with **15 respondents (6.6% valid)**. Smaller proportions of respondents reported parental businesses in the **Yellow Economy** (IT, AI, digitalization; 10 respondents), the **Social and Solidarity Economy** (9 respondents), the **Blue Economy** (7 respondents), the **White Economy** (6 respondents), and both the **Brown** and **Green Economies** (5 respondents each).

Notably, the category **"Other"** comprises the largest share, with **112 respondents (48.9% valid)** selecting this option. This suggests that a significant portion of parental businesses operate in sectors not captured by the predefined categories, reflecting the broad diversity of entrepreneurial activity in the sample. Out of 239 total respondents, **229 provided valid answers**, while **10 cases were missing**, likely indicating that these respondents were unsure of how to classify their parents' business sector.

Overall, the distribution highlights that parental businesses span a wide range of industries, with strong representation in construction-related activities, agriculture, and creative sectors. The large "Other" category underscores the heterogeneity of the business landscape of the sample and suggests that many family enterprises of the sample operate in niche or mixed-sector activities that do not fit neatly into standard economic classifications.

7.6 Your Family Business Experience and Involvement

Figure 17
Share of Respondents Who Have Worked in Family Business



The results show a nearly even distribution: 85 respondents indicated that they have not worked in the family business, while 78 respondents reported that they have. Although the difference is small, the data suggest that slightly more respondents have no direct work experience in their family's business. This item was asked only of respondents with a family business and who are neither active nor nascent entrepreneurs.

This pattern provides insight into the level of early exposure the sampled students have to entrepreneurial activities within their households. The relatively balanced distribution implies that while many students are given opportunities to participate in the family business, an almost equal number may not be involved—possibly due to age, parental preference, business nature, or personal interest. This variation in exposure may influence students' perceptions of entrepreneurship, their confidence in business-related tasks, and their likelihood of considering succession or entrepreneurial careers in the future.

7.7 Family Business Discussions While Growing Up

Respondents were asked to indicate how frequently they discussed family business–related topics with their family while growing up (N = 161). Results show that these discussions occurred with varying frequency, most commonly on an occasional basis (monthly or a few times a year; **33.5%**, n = 54), followed by frequent (weekly) discussions (**23.0%**, n = 37) and rare discussions (only a few times ever; **24.8%**, n = 40). A smaller proportion of respondents reported very frequent (daily) discussions (**13.0%**, n = 21), while only **5.6%** (n = 9) indicated they never discussed family business topics while growing up.

Table 27

Frequency of Family Business Discussions

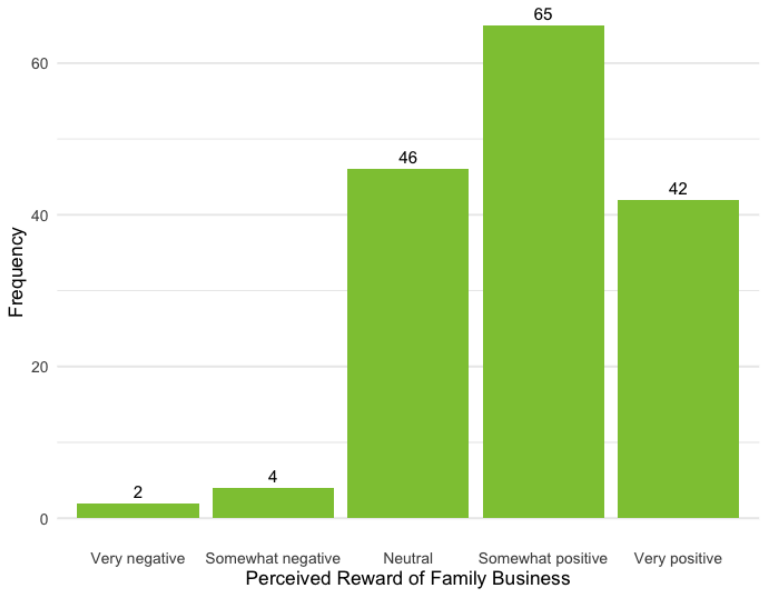
Frequency of Discussion	Count (n)	Percent (%)
Very frequently (daily)	*21*	*13.0*
Frequently (weekly)	*37*	*23.0*
Occasionally (monthly or a few times a year)	*54*	*33.5*
Rarely (only a few times ever)	*40*	*24.8*
Never	*9*	*5.6*
Total Respondents (N)	***161***	***100.0***

When responses were collapsed into broader categories, the majority of respondents (**69.5%**, n = 112) reported having these conversations at least occasionally, compared to **30.4%** (n = 49) who reported rare or no exposure to such discussions. These findings suggest that family business socialization—the informal transmission of business-related knowledge, values, and experiences within the family context—was a relatively common feature of respondents' upbringing. Most respondents were exposed to family business discourse to some degree, though the intensity of this exposure varied considerably across the sample, reflecting differences in family engagement and communication patterns.

7.8 Perception of Rewards from Parental Family Business

Figure 18

Perceived Rewards of Family Business Ownership to Current (Parent) Owners



The figure shows that most respondents view the rewards their parents gain from their businesses positively. Among the 159 respondents with business-owner parents, **67.3%** (n = 107) expressed favorable perceptions—**40.9%** (n = 65) rated them as "somewhat positive," and **26.4%** (n = 42) as "very positive." A smaller group (**28.9%**, n = 46) remained neutral, while only **3.8%** (n = 6) reported negative views.

These results suggest that for this sample, children of family business owners generally associate entrepreneurship with beneficial outcomes. This positive perception may influence their own entrepreneurial intentions, encouraging succession or participation in family enterprises.

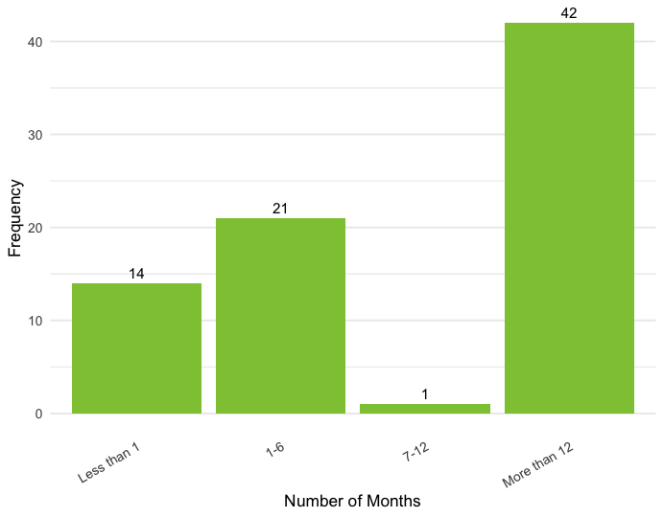
7.9 Age of First Involvement in Family Business

Among the 78 respondents who reported working in their family business, the age of initial involvement ranged from 12 to 21 years, with a mean age of about 15.0. The data show a bimodal pattern: the largest group began at age 12 (**30.8%**, n = 24), reflecting early informal exposure to family business activities, while a second peak at age 18 (**15.4%**, n = 12) corresponds to entry during early adulthood or after secondary education. The remaining respondents were spread across ages 13 to 17 years old (n = 5–9) and 19 to 21 years old (n = 2–3). These results suggest two main pathways of involvement—an early, informal route shaped by family socialization and a later, more deliberate entry as students transition into adulthood and formal work responsibilities.

7.10 Duration of Involvement in Family Business

Figure 19

Frequency Distribution of Total Months Worked in the Family Business



The data on students' work experience within their family enterprises show a wide range of engagement levels. Many respondents reported short-term or seasonal involvement lasting less than six months, while a distinct group demonstrated sustained participation exceeding one year. This variation reflects different depths of family business socialization, where the duration of work serves as an indicator of professional immersion. Shorter engagements often represent casual exposure with limited responsibility, whereas multi-year involvement suggests a deeper apprenticeship marked by the acquisition of firm-specific knowledge and operational familiarity. Such extended experience enhances readiness for succession, as prolonged participation helps students develop both the competence and confidence needed to assume future leadership roles within their family businesses.

7.11 Your Involvement and Experience - Basic Psychological Need Satisfaction and Frustration Among Family Business Respondents

The questionnaire used in this study measures the three core psychological needs defined by Self-Determination Theory (SDT) through the Basic Psychological Need Satisfaction and Frustration Scale (BPNSFS). These needs—autonomy, competence, and relatedness—represent key dimensions of human motivation and well-being within the family business setting. **Autonomy** reflects the sense of freedom and choice in one's actions; **Competence** captures feelings of effectiveness and confidence in achieving goals; and **Relatedness** denotes the sense of connection and belonging with others.

Each domain includes items assessing both satisfaction (positive experiences of need fulfillment) and frustration (negative experiences such as pressure or rejection). Respondents rated their agreement with each statement on a 7-point Likert scale, where 1 = not true at all

and 7 = completely true. Collectively, these measures provide insight into how family business environments nurture or hinder individuals' basic psychological needs, shaping their motivation and engagement within the enterprise.

Table 28

Autonomy Need Satisfaction and Frustration

STATEMENTS ON AUTONOMY	Mean	SD
I feel a sense of choice and freedom in the things I undertake in the family business.	*4.87*	*1.46*
I feel that my decisions regarding our family business reflect what I really want.	*4.74*	*1.52*
I feel my choices regarding our family business express who I really am.	*4.68*	*1.61*
In terms of the family business, I feel I have been doing what really interests me.	*4.74*	*1.52*
Most of the things I do for the family business feel like "I have to".	*4.69*	*1.61*
I feel forced to do many things for the family business I would not choose to do.	*3.54*	*1.91*
I feel pressured to do too many things for the family business.	*3.68*	*1.98*
My daily activities for the family business feel like a chain of obligations.	*3.59*	*2.00*

Table 29

Competence Need Satisfaction and Frustration

STATEMENTS ON COMPETENCE	Mean	SD
I feel confident that I can do things well in the family business.	*4.71*	*1.56*
I feel capable at what I do for the family business.	*4.90*	*1.44*
I feel competent to achieve my goals within the family business.	*4.74*	*1.47*
I feel I can successfully complete difficult tasks for the family business.	*4.78*	*1.49*

STATEMENTS ON COMPETENCE	Mean	SD
I have serious doubts about whether I can do things well for the family business.	*4.24*	*1.74*
I feel disappointed with many of my performances in relation to the family business.	*3.71*	*1.77*
I feel insecure about my abilities to succeed in the family business.	*3.81*	*1.86*
I feel like a failure when it comes to the family business because of the mistakes I make.	*3.58*	*1.90*

Table 30

Relatedness Need Satisfaction and Frustration

STATEMENTS ON RELATEDNESS	Mean	SD
I feel that the people involved in the family business (e.g. family, employees, customers, suppliers) that I care about also care about me.	***5.36***	*1.43*
I feel connected with people in our family business who care for me, and for whom I care.	*5.27*	*1.35*
I feel close and connected with people outside the family business who are important to me.	*5.16*	*1.38*
I experience a warm feeling with the people of the family business I spend time with.	*5.04*	*1.41*
I feel excluded from the family business that I want to belong to.	*3.34*	*2.04*
I feel that people of our family business who are important to me are cold and distant towards me.	*3.11*	*1.91*
I have the impression that the people of the family business I spend time with dislike me.	***3.08***	*1.93*
I feel the relationships I have in the family business are just superficial.	*3.33*	*2.05*

Autonomy Domain

Among the 78 respondents who reported working in their family business, autonomy satisfaction levels were moderate, with means ranging from 4.68 to 4.87, while frustration levels ranged between 3.54 and 3.68. The relatively high standard deviations (1.46–2.00) indicate varied experiences among participants. Overall, respondents felt a fair degree of choice and freedom in their roles—for instance, agreeing with statements such as “I feel a sense of choice and freedom in the things I undertake” (M = 4.87) and “I feel that my decisions reflect what I really want” (M = 4.74). However, frustration items like “I feel forced to do many things I would not choose to do” (M = 3.54) reveal that some participants experience pressure or obligation.

The findings show that family business workers experience moderate autonomy satisfaction, meaning they generally feel some freedom and choice in their roles but not complete independence. Average scores around 4.7 to 4.9 suggest most respondents perceive a fair level of self-direction, though the high variability indicates differing experiences across individuals. Meanwhile, frustration scores between 3.5 and 3.7 reveal that some participants feel constrained or obligated in their tasks. Overall, the results portray a balanced picture—autonomy is present but tempered by occasional feelings of pressure within family business settings.

Competence Domain

Competence satisfaction scores range from 4.71 to 4.90, while frustration scores fall between 3.58 and 4.24, with standard deviations of 1.44–1.90 indicating moderate variability. Overall, respondents feel capable and effective in their family business roles. The highest mean—“I feel capable at what I do” (M = 4.90)—reflects strong confidence in their abilities. However, frustration items such as “I feel insecure about my abilities” (M = 3.81) and “I feel like a failure because of mistakes” (M = 3.58) reveal that some participants experience self-doubt or performance pressure.

These results suggest that competence satisfaction is relatively high, indicating that family businesses provide meaningful opportunities for skill development and mastery. Yet, moderate frustration levels may arise from high expectations or comparisons with senior family members.

Relatedness Domain

Relatedness satisfaction scores are the highest among the three domains, with means ranging from 5.04 to 5.36, while frustration scores are notably lower, between 3.08 and 3.34. Standard deviations (1.35–2.05) indicate moderate variability. Respondents report strong feelings of connection and belonging within their family

businesses, as shown by the item “I feel that the people I care about also care about me” (M = 5.36), which reflects high relational support. In contrast, frustration items such as “I feel excluded from the family business” (M = 3.34) and “I feel relationships are superficial” (M = 3.33) suggest that a minority experience relational strain.

Relatedness emerges as the most satisfied domain, emphasizing the strong emotional bonds and shared identity typical of family enterprises. However, the presence of relational frustration highlights the need for inclusive communication and effective conflict management to prevent feelings of exclusion and maintain healthy interpersonal dynamics within the business.

8. About Your Family

This section explores perceptions of family dynamics among respondents whose parents manage a family business but who are not themselves currently engaged in nascent or active entrepreneurial ventures. Approximately 166 respondents were eligible for this block; per-item sample sizes range from 153 to 165.

8.1 About Your Family Cohesion

This section of the questionnaire examines family cohesion, meaning the emotional bonding, closeness, and mutual support among family members. Respondents rated four statements on a 7-point Likert scale, where 1 = almost never and 7 = almost always.

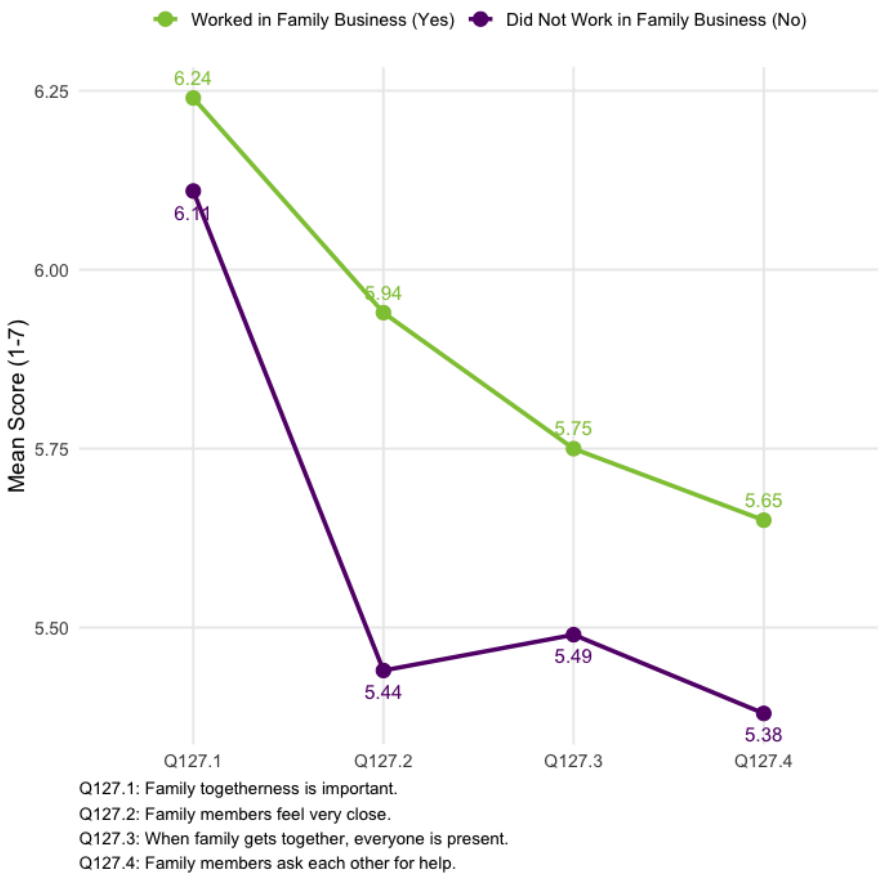
Table 31
Family Cohesion

Statement	Mean	SD
Family togetherness is important.	***6.16***	*1.17*
Family members feel very close.	*5.66*	*1.51*
When family gets together, everyone is present.	*5.60*	*1.55*
Family members ask each other for help.	*5.49*	*1.63*

Respondents reported high levels of family cohesion, with mean scores ranging from 5.49 to 6.16 on a 7-point Likert scale (1 = almost never, 7 = almost always). The highest agreement was for “Family togetherness is important” (M = 6.16, SD = 1.17), followed by “Family members feel very close” (M = 5.66, SD = 1.51) and “Family members ask each other for help” (M = 5.49, SD = 1.63). Unity emerges as a strong family value, with consistent emotional closeness and mutual support across items.

Figure 20

Comparison of Family Cohesion Scores by Work Experience in Family Business



The line graph compares mean scores across four family cohesion items (Q127.1–Q127.4) between respondents who worked in their family business and those who did not. Both groups scored highly, with means from 5.65 to 6.24 on the same 7-point Likert scale. Those involved in the family business scored consistently higher, suggesting that participation may strengthen perceptions of unity, while the stable pattern across both groups indicates that cohesion holds regardless of direct business involvement.

8.2 About Your Family Harmony

Table 32

Mean Scores for Family Harmony

Statement	Mean Score	SD
My family functions well for all members.	*5.61*	*1.42*
My family's day-to-day interactions are peaceful.	*5.28*	*1.63*
Family members accommodate each other.	*5.53*	*1.54*
I am proud of my family.	*6.02*	*1.39*
My family is harmonious.	*5.51*	*1.53*

This section of the questionnaire examines respondents' perceptions of family harmony, meaning the degree of peace, cooperation, and pride within their families. Five statements were rated on a 7-point Likert scale (1 = strongly disagree, 7 = strongly agree) based on Kavikondala et al. (2015). Mean scores ranged from 5.28 to 6.02, indicating generally high agreement. The highest score, "I am proud of my family" (M = 6.02, SD = 1.39), reflects strong family pride, while "My family functions well for all members" (M = 5.61, SD = 1.42) and "Family members accommodate each other" (M = 5.53, SD = 1.54) show cooperative relationships. The lowest mean, "My family's day-to-day interactions are peaceful" (M = 5.28, SD = 1.63), suggests that occasional tension may occur despite overall harmony. Consistent with Kavikondala et al. (2015), this profile of harmony and pride appears to support emotional well-being and household stability.

8.3 Mentoring From Family Members

This section of the questionnaire assesses the mentoring provided by previous-generation family members (e.g., father and/or mother) involved in the family business. Respondents rated nine statements on a 7-point Likert scale (1 = strongly disagree, 7 = strongly agree), based on the Domain-Specific Mentoring Functions Questionnaire (MFQ-9) developed by Castro and Scandura (2004).

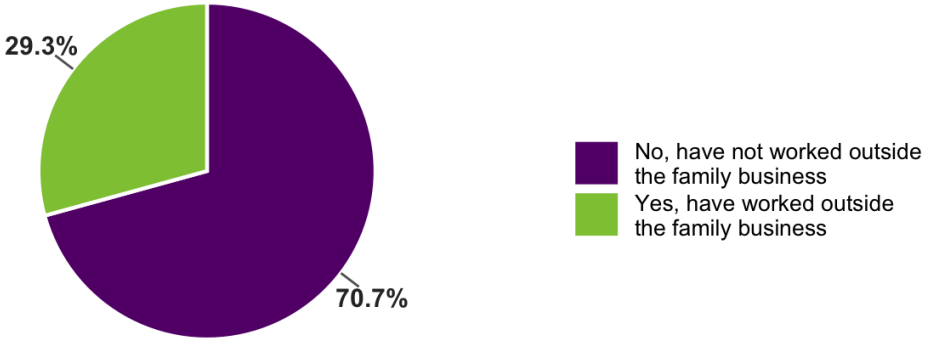
Table 33
Mean Scores for Family Mentoring

Statement	Mean	SD
S/he takes a personal interest in my career.	*5.50*	*1.41*
S/he has devoted special time and consideration to my career.	*5.37*	*1.50*
S/he has shared personal experiences as an alternative perspective to my problems.	*5.42*	*1.50*
I share personal problems with him/her.	***4.94***	*1.88*
I socialize with him/her in my leisure time.	*5.25*	*1.67*
I exchange confidences with him/her.	*5.09*	*1.77*
I try to model my behavior after him/her.	*5.07*	*1.69*
I admire his/her ability to motivate others.	*5.41*	*1.54*
I respect his/her ability to teach others.	***5.61***	*1.52*

Mean scores ranged from 4.94 to 5.61, indicating moderate to high agreement across mentoring dimensions. The highest mean, “I respect his/her ability to teach others” (M = 5.61), shows that respondents especially value their family mentors’ teaching ability, followed by “S/he takes a personal interest in my career” (M = 5.50), “S/he has shared personal experiences as an alternative perspective to my problems” (M = 5.42), and “S/he has devoted special time and consideration to my career” (M = 5.37). The lowest mean, “I share personal problems with him/her” (M = 4.94), suggests that some boundaries remain between personal and professional matters. Consistent with Castro and Scandura (2004), family mentors appear to provide both psychosocial and career-related functions, fostering confidence and continuity across generations in this sample.

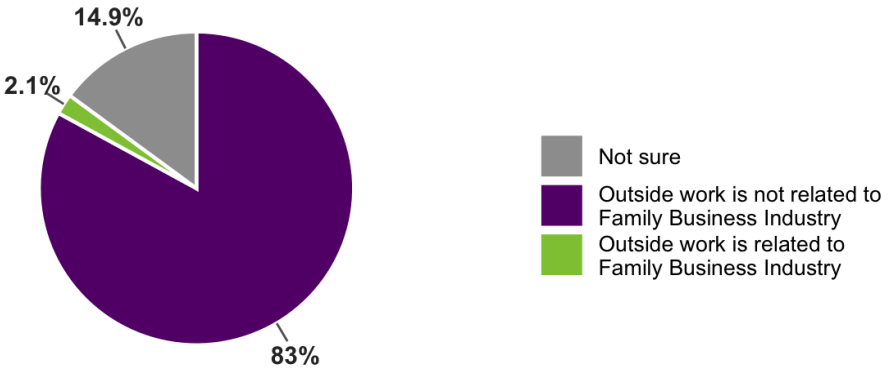
8.4 Your Further Work Experience

Figure 21
Successors’ Work Experience Outside Family Business



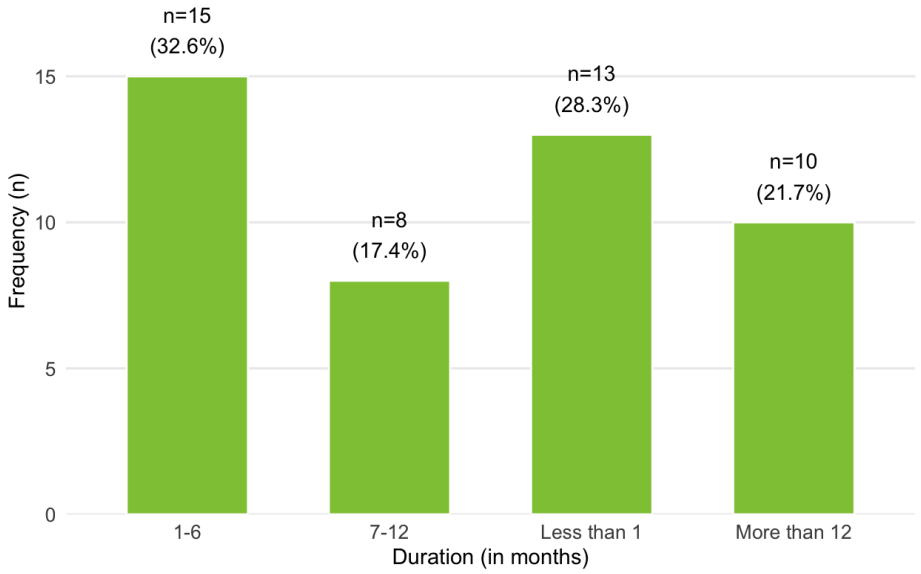
Out of 164 respondents, only **29%** reported having work experience outside their family business. Among the 46 who reported the duration of that experience, **28%** worked less than 1 month, **33%** worked 1-6 months, **17%** worked 7-12 months, and **22%** worked more than 12 months. The majority therefore have relatively short exposure to external work, and only 1 of 47 respondents stated that their non-family work experience was related to their family business’s industry.

Figure 22
Non-Family Business Work Experience Industry to Family Business Industry



Professional experience beyond the family enterprise is therefore limited, and where it exists it is rarely aligned with the family business' industry. The pattern indicates heavy reliance on internal, family-based learning, which may limit external skill acquisition.

Figure 23
Months Worked Outside Family Business



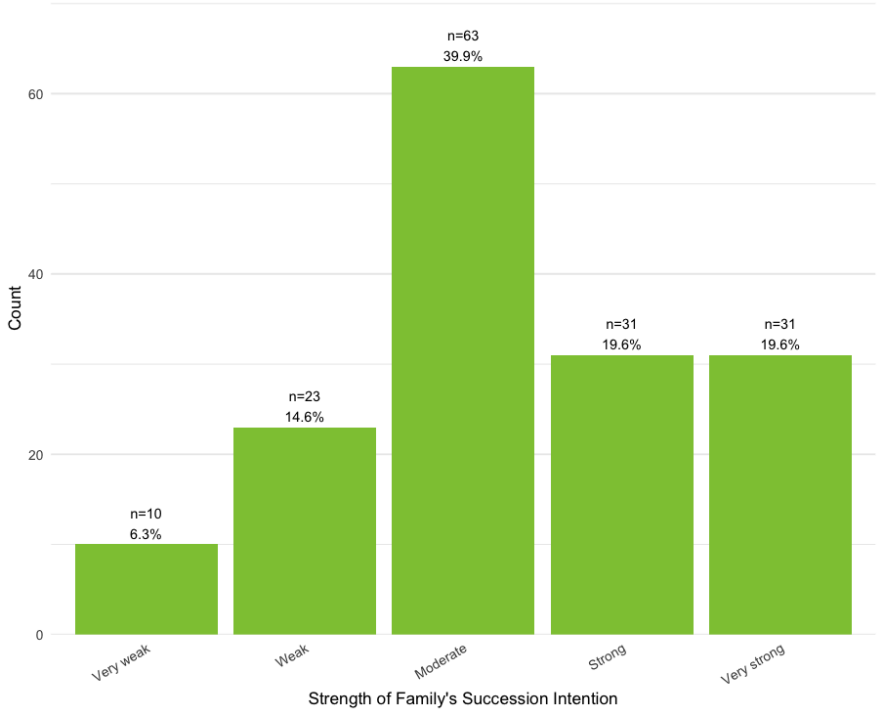
8.5 Intention to Pass the Business to Next Generation

Succession planning secures the continuity of family businesses across generations by preparing future leaders, defining roles, and establishing strategies for transferring ownership and management. In this part of the study, 5 of the 163 participants did not respond to the statements on Family Succession, so only 158 respondents (N = 158) were included in the analysis. These respondents evaluated their family's intention to pass the business to the next generation, the clarity of succession plans, and the degree of shared vision between generations.

The survey asked respondents, "How strong is your family's intention to pass the business on to the next generation?" Out of 158 valid responses, **39.9%** indicated a moderate intention, while **19.6%** each reported strong and very strong intentions. Smaller proportions expressed weak (**14.6%**) and very weak (**6.3%**) intentions.

Figure 24

Succession Planning Level of Family Business

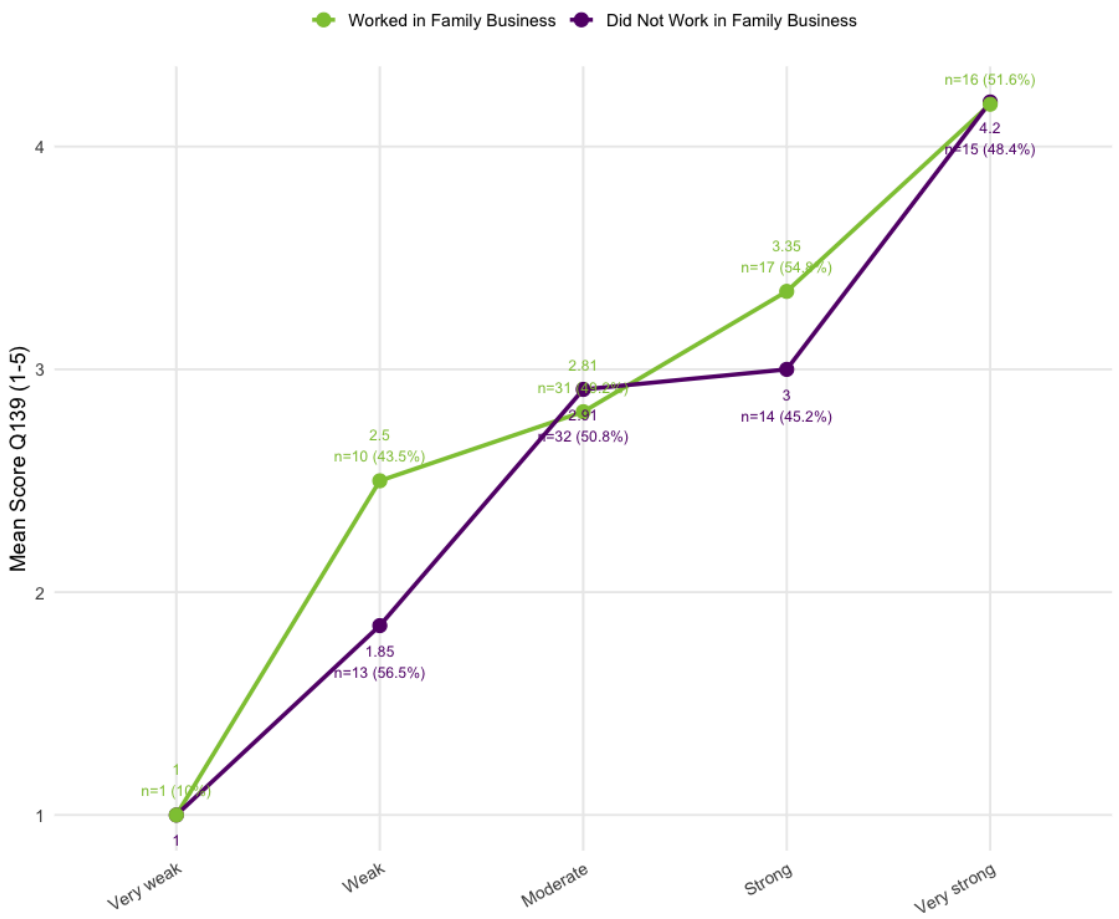


The predominance of moderate responses suggests that families recognize the importance of generational continuity while formal succession frameworks are still developing, and the combined **39.2%** reporting strong or very strong intentions marks a substantial group committed to preserving ownership and leadership within the lineage. Succession here is in a transitional phase: intent is rising, structured planning is not.

8.6 Parental Desire for Takeover

Figure 25

Succession Intention by Parental Takeover Desire and Family Business Work Experience

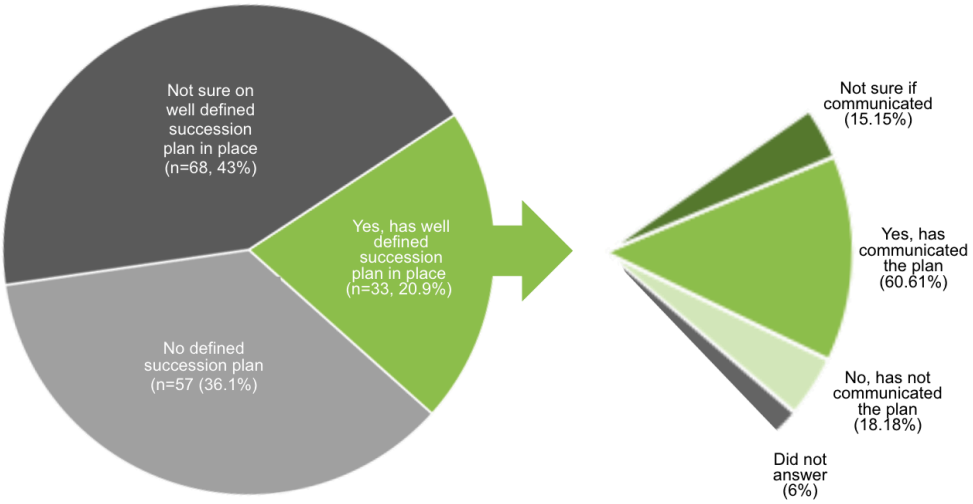


Parental encouragement for succession remains consistently strong among the respondents' family enterprises, regardless of whether next-generation members have prior work experience in the family business. The close alignment of mean scores between groups suggests that succession expectations are embedded in family values and traditions rather than shaped by professional involvement in this sample.

8.7 Existence of a Succession Plan

Figure 26

Existence of a Formal Succession Plan in the Family Business and If the Plan Was Communicated to Stakeholders (for Those with Plan)



Respondents were asked whether their family business had a well-defined succession plan, with options of “Yes,” “No,” and “Not sure.” Among 158 participants, **36.1%** reported having no succession plan, while **20.9%** indicated that a plan exists. Within this group, **3.8%** said the plan had not been communicated, **12.7%** confirmed that it had been communicated to stakeholders, and **3.2%** were unsure about its communication status.

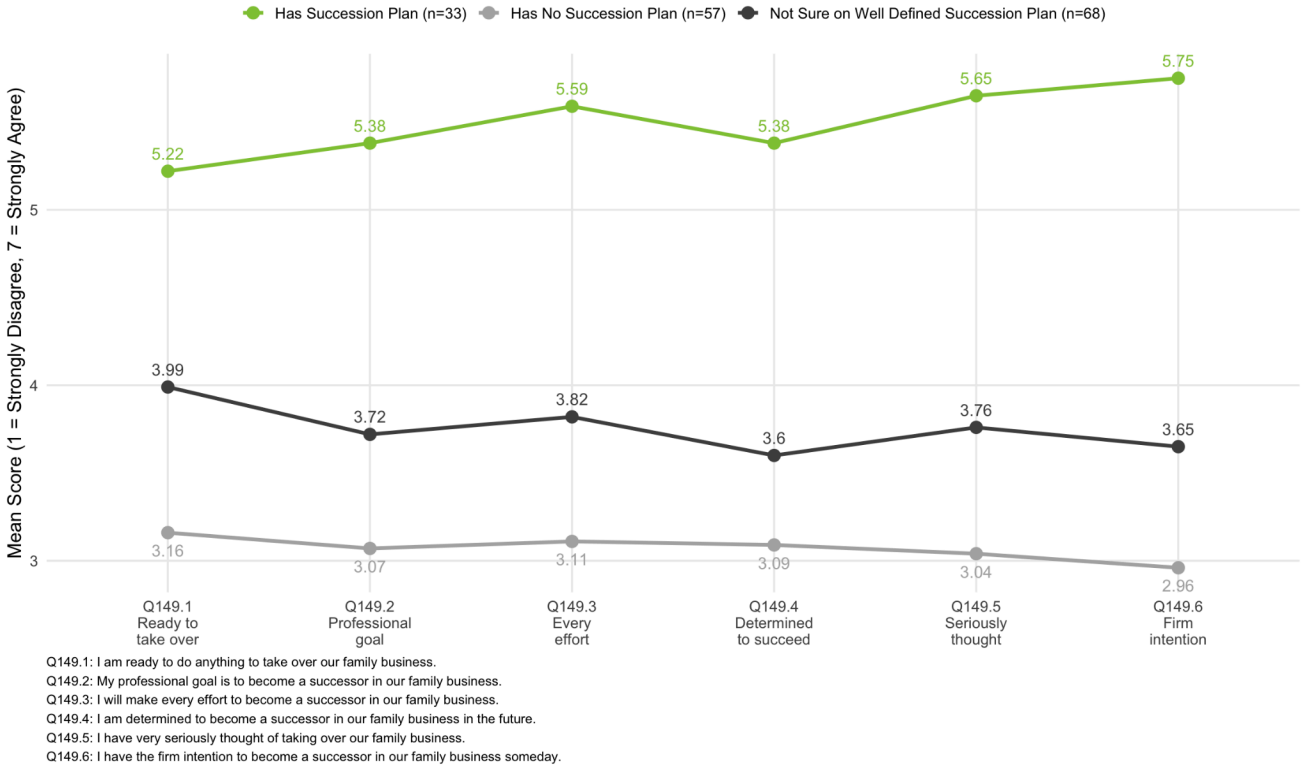
Formal succession planning therefore remains limited: only about one in five families has a defined plan and fewer still have communicated it, indicating that transitions rely heavily on informal family arrangements and pointing to a gap in transparency and stakeholder engagement. Strong parental desire and moderate family intention reflect emotional and cultural readiness, but the absence of formalized plans marks a clear operational gap.

8.8 Domain-Specific Succession Intention

The results demonstrate a strong and consistent pattern: individuals who report having a formal succession plan exhibit substantially higher succession intentions across all six items of the Succession Intention Scale. Their mean scores range from approximately 5.22 to 5.75, indicating a solid commitment to eventually taking over the family business, viewing succession as a professional goal, and being determined to succeed in that role. In contrast, respondents without a succession plan show markedly lower intention levels, with mean scores clustered between 2.96 and 3.16. Respondents who are unsure whether a plan exists (n = 68) fall in between (means 3.60–3.99).

Figure 27

Mean Scores of Succession Intention by Presence of a Family Business Succession Plan

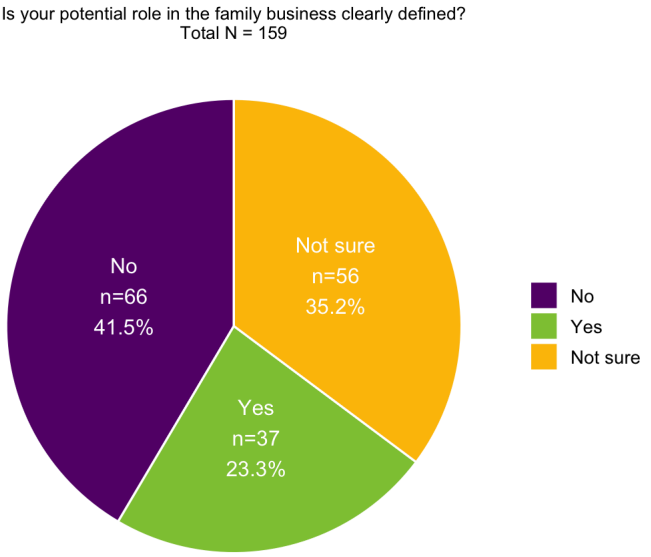


The presence of a succession plan is therefore closely associated with stronger psychological readiness and motivation to assume leadership for this sample: a formal plan may signal clarity, support, and legitimacy, while its absence may create ambiguity or reflect weaker family encouragement. Because the gap holds across every item, succession planning appears to reinforce a broad set of motivational dimensions, including readiness, effort, determination, and long-term commitment. Future research could test whether plan quality, generational dynamics, or communication patterns further moderate these levels.

8.9 Clarity of Potential Role in the Family Business

Figure 28

Clarity of Successor Role Definition in the Family Business



Respondents were asked whether their potential role in the family business was clearly defined. The results show a notable lack of clarity: **41.5%** reported that their role is *not* clearly defined, while only **23.3%** indicated that it *is* clearly defined. A substantial **35.2%** were *not sure* about their role.

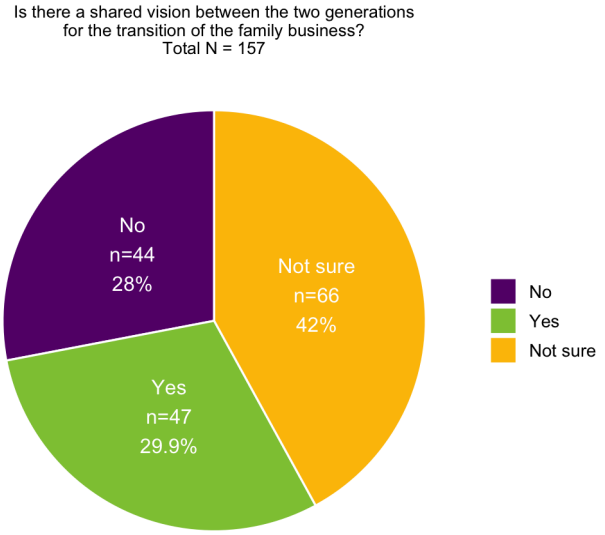
Role ambiguity at this scale is a structural gap in succession preparation: even in families with succession intentions or formal plans, many next-generation members cannot describe their future responsibilities, authority, or leadership trajectory, which erodes motivation and confidence. Read against the succession intention results, this indicates that **formal planning alone is not sufficient**. Clear role definition is the missing link between a succession plan and successor engagement for this sample.

8.10 Shared Vision for Family Business Transition

Respondents were asked whether there is a shared vision between the two generations regarding the transition of the family business. The results reveal substantial uncertainty and fragmentation in intergenerational alignment. A large portion of respondents (**42%**) reported being not sure whether such a shared vision exists. Meanwhile, only **29.9%** indicated that a shared vision is present, and **28%** stated that no shared vision exists.

Figure 29

Existence of a Shared Vision for Family Business Succession

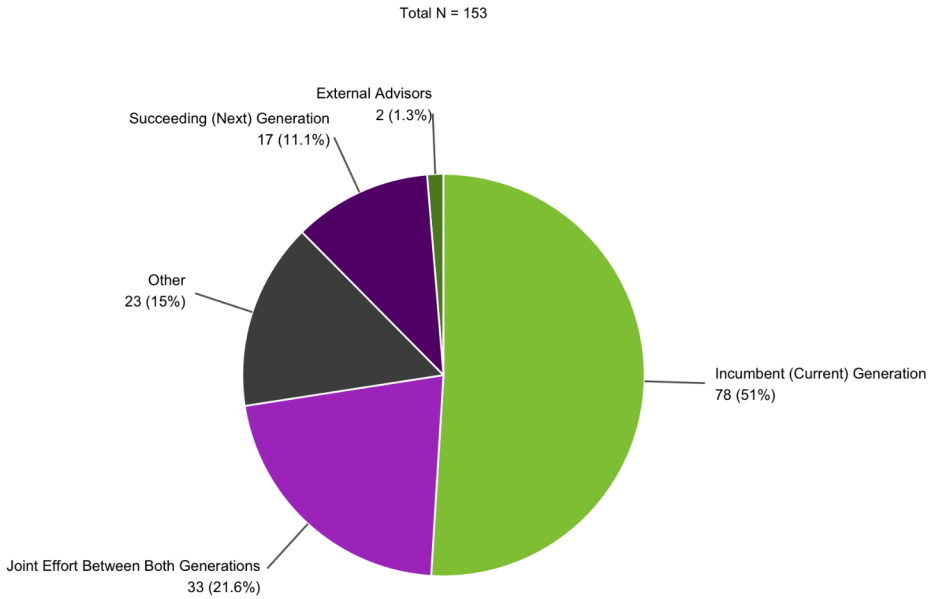


A shared vision aligns expectations, reduces conflict, and enables a smooth leadership transition, so this level of uncertainty suggests that many families are not openly discussing future leadership, business direction, or transition timelines. This is consistent with the earlier findings on unclear roles and inconsistent planning. The near-even Yes/No split shows that alignment is not guaranteed even where those conversations have begun, raising the risk of delayed planning and leadership vacuums. Succession is therefore a relational as well as a structural process for this sample.

8.11 Primary Responsibility for Initiating the Succession Process

Figure 30

Primary Responsibility for Initiating Succession Process



Respondents were asked who holds the primary responsibility for initiating the succession process in their family business. The results show a clear concentration of responsibility within the incumbent generation. A majority (**51%**) indicated that the current

generation leads the succession process. In contrast, only **11.1%** reported that the next generation initiates succession discussions. Another **21.6%** described the process as a joint effort between both generations, while smaller proportions attributed responsibility to external advisors (**1.3%**) or other actors (**15%**).

This concentration reflects traditional family-enterprise dynamics, in which the incumbent generation retains control of strategic decisions and successors remain reactive, a pattern that plausibly contributes to the earlier findings of unclear roles and limited shared vision. The modest share of joint efforts (**21.6%**) shows that collaborative succession planning is not yet widespread, while minimal external-advisor involvement (**1.3%**) points to internal decision-making over professional facilitation. Encouraging shared responsibility may strengthen communication and role clarity, given the strong succession intentions observed among those with formal plans.

8.12 Performance

Respondents evaluated their family business's performance relative to competitors over the past three years across five dimensions: sales growth, market share growth, profit growth, job creation, and innovativeness. Each dimension was rated on a 7-point scale (1 = much worse, 7 = much better), following established firm-performance measures (Dess & Robinson, 1984; Eddleston et al., 2008).

Table 35
Perceived Family Business Performance (Vs. Competitors)

Dimension	n	Mean	SD
Sales growth	*158*	***4.70***	*1.42*
Market Share growth	*155*	*4.46*	*1.51*
Profit growth	*157*	*4.69*	*1.37*
Job creation	*157*	*4.28*	*1.67*
Innovativeness	*156*	***4.22***	*1.61*

All indicators exceed the midpoint (4.0), indicating that respondents generally perceive their family businesses as performing slightly better than competitors. Sales growth and profit growth are strongest, suggesting steady financial progress, while job creation and innovativeness register lower scores despite remaining above average. The profile is competitive but stable and strongest in financial outcomes; the more moderate non-financial results may reflect structural constraints or leadership transitions that limit agility and innovation, issues closely linked to succession readiness.

9. Main Findings and Recommendations

9.1 Summary

The **GUESSS 2025 Philippines National Report** reveals a dynamic and evolving entrepreneurial landscape among sampled university students in the Philippines. Based on responses from 669 students across more than 20 higher education institutions, the findings show strong entrepreneurial aspirations but uneven educational exposure and structural challenges influencing entrepreneurial behavior. Overall, the report identifies a large latent entrepreneurial pipeline and notable early-stage engagement, highlighting opportunities for universities, policymakers, and ecosystem actors to strengthen innovation capacity and youth entrepreneurship. Key recommendations include expanding entrepreneurship education, enhancing mentorship and incubation programs, improving access to financing, promoting interdisciplinary collaboration, and forming a national multi-university consortium to unify efforts and drive inclusive, innovation-led growth.

Table 36
Summary of Findings and Recommendations

Focus Area	Key Recommendations	Intended Impact
Latent Entrepreneurial Pipeline	Implement *Entrepreneurial Discovery Tracks*, *Post-Graduation Incubation Programs*, and *Career-to-Startup Bridging Initiatives*.	Convert long-term entrepreneurial intentions into active ventures.
Early Entrepreneurial Engagement	Strengthen mentorship, seed funding, and industry network access; embed entrepreneurship in academic life.	Support student ventures from ideation to market entry.
Family Modeling & Networks	Create structured mentorship and alumni programs to replicate family entrepreneurial advantages.	Democratize access to entrepreneurial role models and social capital.
Education Exposure	Expand experiential learning, interdisciplinary collaboration, and mentorship in curricula.	Transform entrepreneurial interest into actionable capability.
Ecosystem Barriers	Develop student-focused financing (micro-grants, seed funds), advisory services, and interdisciplinary linkages.	Reduce structural barriers and promote venture formalization.
Universities & HEIs	Make entrepreneurship education compulsory; create mentor networks; advocate for *student business permits*.	Institutionalize entrepreneurship and encourage early venture formation.
Multi-University Consortia (PUEIC)	Form a national consortium for policy advocacy, curriculum standardization, resource sharing, and research collaboration.	Align university efforts with national innovation goals and foster inclusive growth.

9.2 A Large and Latent Entrepreneurial Pipeline

The central finding is the **gap between near-term and long-term founder intention** **14.2%** of students intend to found a business immediately after studies, while **38.4%** intend to do so five years later. Most of these intending founders are not yet active or nascent

entrepreneurs.. This **latent majority** represents the highest-potential segment for intervention.

Universities must therefore design programs that reach beyond self-declared entrepreneurs to include students who may transition into entrepreneurship after gaining initial career experience. Early exposure to entrepreneurial thinking—through foundational courses, mentorship, and experiential learning—can help convert intention into action and sustain the country's long-term innovation momentum.

To activate this latent pipeline, higher-education institutions can implement **three strategic interventions**:

1. **Entrepreneurial Discovery Tracks** – Introduce elective or co-curricular pathways that allow students from any discipline to explore entrepreneurship through short modules, ideation workshops, and innovation challenges. These tracks help students recognize entrepreneurial opportunities within their fields of study.
2. **Post-Graduation Incubation Programs** – Establish university-affiliated incubators that remain accessible to alumni for one to two years after graduation. This ensures continuity of support as students transition from academic environments to real-world venture creation.
3. **Career-to-Startup Bridging Initiatives** – Partner with industry to create programs where early-career professionals can transform workplace insights into entrepreneurial ventures. These initiatives connect practical experience with startup formation, reinforcing entrepreneurship as a natural extension of professional growth.

By cultivating this latent entrepreneurial pipeline, higher education institutions can play a pivotal role in transforming entrepreneurial aspiration into tangible enterprise creation, ensuring that the next generation of Filipino innovators is equipped to drive inclusive and sustainable economic growth.

9.3 Strong Early Entrepreneurial Engagement

The combined share of active and nascent entrepreneurs— one in five students (**20.6%**)—demonstrates **robust early-stage entrepreneurial activity** among Filipino university students. This finding justifies ongoing investments in **incubation, pre-incubation, and venture support infrastructure** within higher education institutions. The presence of active founders at the undergraduate level reflects growing confidence in entrepreneurship as a viable career path.

Such early engagement highlights the importance of **institutional mechanisms that nurture ventures from ideation to market entry**. Universities should strengthen support

systems that provide mentorship, seed funding, and access to industry networks, enabling students to refine ideas and scale prototypes into sustainable enterprises. Embedding entrepreneurship within academic life—through innovation hubs, startup competitions, and cross-disciplinary collaboration—can further accelerate this momentum.

Ultimately, the strong participation of young founders signals a cultural shift toward **entrepreneurial self-determination**, positioning universities as critical incubators of innovation and national economic renewal.

9.4 Family Modeling and Entrepreneurial Networks as Key Drivers

Family background is closely associated with entrepreneurial intention in this sample. Students from entrepreneurial households consistently demonstrate stronger motivation and confidence to pursue business ventures compared to those from non-entrepreneurial families. This finding underscores the role of **social modeling and network exposure** in shaping entrepreneurial mindsets. Students grow up observing entrepreneurial behavior—decision-making, risk-taking, and opportunity recognition—can internalize these patterns as viable career pathways.

Universities can replicate these advantages through **structured mentorship programs, alumni networks, and peer communities** that provide similar relational and experiential learning benefits. By connecting students with experienced founders and industry practitioners, institutions can offer the kind of guidance and social capital that entrepreneurial families naturally provide. These networks not only foster collaboration and knowledge exchange but also help democratize access to entrepreneurial role models across socioeconomic backgrounds, ensuring that every student has the opportunity to learn from lived entrepreneurial experience

9.5 Education Exposure and Learning Outcomes

A significant portion of respondents (**33.3%**) reported having no formal exposure to entrepreneurship education. Average perceived learning scores exceed 5.0 on the 7-point scale. This pattern highlights the transformative potential of structured entrepreneurial learning experiences in shaping students' confidence, competence, and career orientation.

Rather than relying solely on a supportive institutional climate, the data emphasize the importance of **hands-on skill acquisition**—particularly in opportunity recognition, customer validation, and resource mobilization. These competencies translate abstract entrepreneurial interest into actionable capability, enabling students to move from ideation to venture creation. The evidence suggests that entrepreneurship education functions not merely as a curricular supplement but as a **strategic catalyst** for entrepreneurial intention and behavior.

Expanding equitable access to high-quality entrepreneurship education therefore represents a key intervention available to Philippine higher education institutions. By embedding experiential learning, interdisciplinary collaboration, and mentorship within academic programs, universities can convert latent entrepreneurial potential into tangible enterprise development—strengthening both the innovation capacity of students and the broader national entrepreneurship ecosystem.

9.6 Ecosystem Barriers and Structural Gaps

Despite strong entrepreneurial aspirations among Philippine university students, the broader ecosystem continues to present **structural barriers** that constrain venture creation and growth. The most acute challenge remains **access to financing**, with **bank loan inaccessibility** among nascent entrepreneurs—a clear indication that traditional credit channels are not designed for student entrepreneurs. Most financial institutions require collateral, credit history, or formal business registration, all of which are typically unavailable to young founders. This structural mismatch underscores the need for **grant-based programs**, **alternative financing literacy**, and **university-supported pathways** to government and private-sector funding.

To address these gaps, universities and policymakers should collaborate to establish **student-focused financing mechanisms**, such as micro-grants, convertible seed funds, and innovation vouchers. These instruments can help students validate ideas, build prototypes, and transition from informal ventures to registered enterprises. Financial literacy programs should also emphasize **non-traditional funding models**—crowdfunding, angel networks, and social impact investment—to expand the range of accessible capital sources.

Another important challenge is the **transition from entrepreneurial exploration to formal venture creation**. Although many respondents reported engaging in ideation and market validation activities, comparatively few advanced to formal business registration. This gap suggests that students may encounter obstacles related to regulatory requirements, legal processes, financing constraints, and limited access to institutional support. **Strengthening university-based advisory services, registration assistance, and intellectual property support mechanisms** may help lower these barriers and encourage venture formalization.

Beyond the survey data, we observe a further barrier in the **underdeveloped collaboration between STEM and business disciplines**. While technical innovation is emerging across engineering and computer science programs, commercialization remains limited due to weak integration with business and management education. This disconnect restricts the translation of research outputs and prototypes into viable market solutions. Strengthening **interdisciplinary linkages**—through joint courses, co-mentorship, and shared

incubation spaces—can unlock high-value innovation opportunities and foster a culture of co-creation between technical and entrepreneurial talent.

Finally, in our assessment, the ecosystem suffers from **fragmented institutional coordination**. Many universities operate in isolation, leading to duplication of efforts and uneven access to support infrastructure. Establishing **regional innovation clusters** and **multi-university consortia** can help harmonize resources, share best practices, and create a unified platform for national entrepreneurship advocacy.

9.7 Implications for Universities, Policymakers, and Ecosystem Actors

9.7.1 For Universities and HEIs

Expanding entrepreneurship education should be a **core institutional priority**, ensuring that every student—regardless of discipline—gains meaningful exposure to entrepreneurial thinking and innovation processes. Even a single compulsory introductory module could expand exposure and cultivate a mindset of creativity, adaptability, and self-reliance.

Pedagogy must be **outcomes-driven**, emphasizing the development of **practical competencies** such as opportunity recognition, resource mobilization, and venture execution rather than relying solely on theoretical instruction. Embedding **experiential learning**—through simulations, internships, hackathons, and project-based courses—enables students to translate abstract concepts into actionable ventures and strengthens their confidence in entrepreneurial decision-making.

Equally vital is the **creation of structured entrepreneurial networks**. Mentor-matching programs, alumni engagement, and founder communities provide students with access to guidance, social capital, and real-world insights that accelerate learning and venture growth. These networks replicate the relational advantages observed in entrepreneurial families, democratizing access to mentorship and role modeling across socioeconomic backgrounds.

To further institutionalize student entrepreneurship, universities — working with local governments and national agencies — should advocate for the **establishment of a student-level temporary business permit**, analogous to a “student driver’s license.” This permit would allow students to legally operate small-scale ventures while enrolled, providing a **regulated, low-risk environment** for experimentation and learning. Such a mechanism would:

- Simplify compliance and registration for student-led startups.
- Encourage early venture formation and commercialization of academic projects.
- Serve as a bridge between academic incubation and formal enterprise registration.
- Foster accountability and legitimacy for student entrepreneurs engaging with external partners.

Finally, universities should actively promote **interdisciplinary collaboration and internationalization**. Integrating business, engineering, and computer science programs bridges innovation and commercialization, while global partnerships, exchange programs, and cross-border incubation initiatives expose students to diverse markets and entrepreneurial cultures. This global orientation not only enhances competitiveness but also positions Filipino student entrepreneurs to scale ventures internationally and contribute to the country's innovation-driven development agenda.

9.7.2 For Multi-University Consortia

To accelerate national progress in entrepreneurship and innovation, universities should **form a Philippine University Entrepreneurship and Innovation Consortium (PUEIC)**—a collaborative alliance of higher education institutions committed to advancing entrepreneurial education, research, and ecosystem development.

This consortium would serve as a **collective advocacy and coordination platform**, enabling universities to speak together on national policy reforms, startup support frameworks, and standardized entrepreneurship education. By pooling expertise and resources, the consortium can foster a more coherent national innovation strategy.

Strategic Objectives:

- **Policy Advocacy:** Engage with government agencies to shape youth entrepreneurship policies, funding programs, and regulatory frameworks that support student-led ventures.
- **Curriculum Standardization:** Develop shared benchmarks for entrepreneurship education, ensuring consistent quality and measurable learning outcomes across institutions.

- **Resource Sharing:** Establish joint incubation networks, mentorship pools, and research collaborations that reduce duplication and expand access to entrepreneurial support.
- **Data and Research Collaboration:** Coordinate national-level studies on entrepreneurial behavior, outcomes, and ecosystem effectiveness to inform evidence-based policymaking.
- **Regional Inclusion:** Ensure participation from universities across Luzon, Visayas, and Mindanao to promote equitable access to innovation opportunities nationwide.

Through unified action, the consortium can **align university efforts with national innovation goals**, **strengthen the entrepreneurial pipeline**, and **position Philippine higher education as a key driver of inclusive, innovation-led growth**. This collaborative model will not only enhance institutional capacity but also create a sustainable foundation for an interconnected entrepreneurial ecosystem.

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